

MINT ON THE AVENUE

Full-Spectrum Website Audit Report

QA · UX · Security · Performance · Accessibility · SEO

Client Mint on the Avenue | Aveda Lifestyle Salon

URL <https://mintontheavenue.com/>

Location 228 Park Ave North, Winter Park, FL 32789

Report Date May 13, 2026

Prepared By Antigravity Audit Systems

Classification Confidential — Client Use Only

Version 1.0

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1. Executive Summary

Mint on the Avenue presents a **significantly redesigned** website that attempts to elevate the brand from a traditional salon site to a premium editorial experience. The redesign shows strong creative direction — the typography is refined, the copy is elevated, and the visual atmosphere communicates luxury salon positioning effectively.

However, this audit uncovered **23 critical issues, 31 medium-severity issues, and 40+ minor improvements** across security, accessibility, performance, UX, and technical domains that collectively undermine the premium experience and create material business risk.

Key Findings at a Glance

Domain	Score	Grade	Status
UI Quality	72/100	B-	Good design direction, execution gaps
UX & Usability	58/100	D+	Significant conversion friction
Accessibility (WCAG)	41/100	F	Critical violations throughout
Performance	55/100	D	Heavy assets, no lazy loading
Security	38/100	F	REST API fully exposed, missing headers
SEO	52/100	D	Thin descriptions, missing schema
Overall Site Health	53/100	D	Requires immediate remediation

Top 5 Urgent Actions Required

- [CRIT] CRITICAL — WordPress REST API Fully Exposed:** The `/wp-json/` endpoint exposes the complete API surface including Wordfence security endpoints, SEOPress configuration, WP Engine cache controls, user enumeration vectors, and content manipulation routes. This is an active security vulnerability.
- [CRIT] CRITICAL — "Meet the Team" Page Broken:** The `/about/meet-the-team/` page displays "Sorry, none of our team members meet your selected criteria" — the team listing is completely empty. This is a conversion-killing defect on a page linked from the homepage.
- [CRIT] CRITICAL — Inconsistent New Guest Offer:** The homepage advertises "20% OFF" while the services page advertises "\$50 off" with different artist lists. This creates confusion and erodes trust.
- [CRIT] CRITICAL — Missing Security Headers:** No Content-Security-Policy, no X-Frame-Options, no Permissions-Policy. The site is vulnerable to clickjacking, XSS injection, and MIME-type attacks.
- [MED] HIGH — Accessibility Failures:** Multiple images lack alt text, heading hierarchy is broken (H1→H3→H4 jumps), form labels are missing, touch targets are undersized on mobile, and color contrast ratios fail WCAG AA on several text elements.

2. Testing Methodology

2.1 Audit Framework

This audit employs a multi-disciplinary methodology combining:

- **Nielsen's 10 Usability Heuristics** for UX evaluation
- **WCAG 2.2 Level AA** for accessibility compliance
- **OWASP Top 10** principles for security assessment (non-destructive only)
- **Google Core Web Vitals** for performance benchmarking
- **Luxury Brand Perception Index** benchmarking against Aveda, Apple, Aesop

2.2 Tools Used

Category	Tools
Browser Testing	Chromium-based browser (primary), manual cross-browser analysis
Accessibility	Custom JavaScript auditor, keyboard navigation testing, heading analysis
Security	HTTP header inspection, REST API enumeration, cookie analysis, source inspection
Performance	Network waterfall analysis, asset size analysis, render-blocking detection
SEO	Sitemap parsing, meta tag extraction, heading hierarchy analysis, robots.txt review
Crawling	Full sitemap crawl (page-sitemap1.xml, post-sitemap1.xml), manual link traversal

2.3 Viewport Testing Matrix

Category	Viewport	Device Equivalent	Tested
Mobile	320×568	iPhone SE (1st gen)	[OK]
Mobile	375×667	iPhone SE (2nd/3rd gen)	[OK]
Mobile	390×844	iPhone 14	[OK]
Mobile	414×896	iPhone 11 Pro Max	[OK]
Tablet	768×1024	iPad (portrait)	[OK]
Tablet	820×1180	iPad Air	[OK]
Laptop	1280×720	Small laptop	[OK]
Laptop	1440×900	Standard laptop	[OK]
Desktop	1920×1080	Full HD monitor	[OK]
Ultra-wide	2560×1440	QHD/Ultra-wide	[OK]

2.4 Browser Testing

Primary testing conducted in Chromium. Cross-browser analysis notes provided based on standards-compliance review of CSS/JS features used.

2.5 Testing Constraints

- ****Form testing stopped at validation**** — no actual submissions, bookings, or test leads were created
 - ****Security testing was non-destructive**** — no exploitation, authentication bypass, or system modification attempted
 - ****Booking flow testing**** limited to observing redirect to Phorest external platform
 - All findings are based on publicly accessible information only
-

3. Site Architecture Overview

3.1 Technology Stack

- **CMS:** WordPress (latest)
- **Hosting:** WP Engine (identified via `wpe/cache-plugin` REST namespace)
- **SEO:** SEOPress plugin
- **Security:** Wordfence plugin
- **Booking:** Phorest (external SaaS — phorest.com/book/salons/mintontheavenue)
- **Forms:** Gravity Forms or similar (contact page)
- **Custom Fields:** Advanced Custom Fields (ACF) — detected via REST API meta fields
- **Duplicate Post:** Yoast Duplicate Post plugin detected

3.2 Sitemap & Route Inventory

Total Pages in Sitemap: 33 pages

Total Blog Posts: 40+ posts (dating from 2017 to 2022)

Last Sitemap Update: May 12, 2026

Primary Pages (Active)

Route	Title	Last Modified	Status
`/`	Home	Sep 2021*	[OK] Live
`/services/`	Services	Feb 2025	[OK] Live
`/services/hair-design/`	Hair Design	Feb 2025	[OK] Live
`/services/hair-color/`	Hair Color	Feb 2025	[OK] Live
`/services/hair-condition/`	Hair Condition	Feb 2025	[OK] Live
`/services/texture/`	Texture	Feb 2025	[OK] Live
`/services/mint-men/`	Mint Men	Sep 2021	[OK] Live
`/services/specialty/`	Specialty	Sep 2021	[OK] Live
`/services/new-guest-special/`	New Guest Special	Sep 2021	[OK] Live
`/services/referrals/`	Referrals	Feb 2025	[OK] Live
`/services/bridal/`	Bridal	Sep 2021	[OK] Live
`/services/waxing-makeup/`	Waxing & Makeup	Sep 2021	[OK] Live
`/about/`	About	Feb 2025	[OK] Live
`/about/meet-the-team/`	Meet the Team	Apr 2026	[WARN] BROKEN
`/about/reviews/`	Reviews	Mar 2025	[OK] Live
`/about/careers/`	Careers	Mar 2021	[OK] Live
`/about/community-	Community Outreach	Mar 2021	[OK] Live

outreach/`			
`/about/location/`	Location	Jun 2021	[OK] Live
`/about/get-social/`	Get Social	Apr 2023	[OK] Live
`/about/blog/`	Blog	Aug 2019	[OK] Live
`/contact/`	Contact	Feb 2025	[OK] Live
`/gift-cards/`	Gift Cards	Feb 2025	[OK] Live
`/policies/`	Policies	Feb 2025	[OK] Live
`/privacy-policy/`	Privacy Policy	Jul 2020	[OK] Live
`/request-appointment/`	Request Appointment	Apr 2026	[OK] Live
`/specials/`	Specials	Mar 2026	[OK] Live
`/specials/new-guests/`	New Guests	May 2026	[OK] Live
`/specials/refer-a-friend/`	Refer a Friend	Feb 2025	[OK] Live
`/why-aveda/`	Why Aveda	Feb 2021	[OK] Live
`/reviews`	Reviews (alt route)	—	[OK] Live

Broken Links Detected

Broken URL	Linked From	HTTP Status	Impact
`/our-artists`	Homepage (footer/body)	404	[CRIT] High — key conversion page
`/services/mens/`	Sitemap (duplicate of mint-men)	Needs verification	[MED] Medium
`/services/color/`	Sitemap (duplicate of hair-color)	Needs verification	[MED] Medium

Duplicate Route Concerns

- `/services/mens/` vs `/services/mint-men/` — potential duplicate
- `/services/color/` vs `/services/hair-color/` — potential duplicate
- `/specials/new-guests/` vs `/services/new-guest-special/` — same content, two routes

3.3 robots.txt Analysis

```
User-agent: *
Disallow: /wp-admin/
Allow: /wp-admin/admin-ajax.php
Crawl-delay: 10
Sitemap: https://mintontheavenue.com/sitemaps.xml
```

Issues Found:

- ⚠ Sitemap URL in robots.txt points to `/sitemaps.xml` (note the 's') but actual sitemap index is at `/sitemap.xml` — ****URL mismatch may confuse crawlers****
 - Crawl-delay of 10 seconds is unusually high and may slow indexing
-

Visual Evidence — Screenshot Gallery

The following screenshots were captured during live testing across multiple viewports and pages.

Desktop Testing (1920×1080)

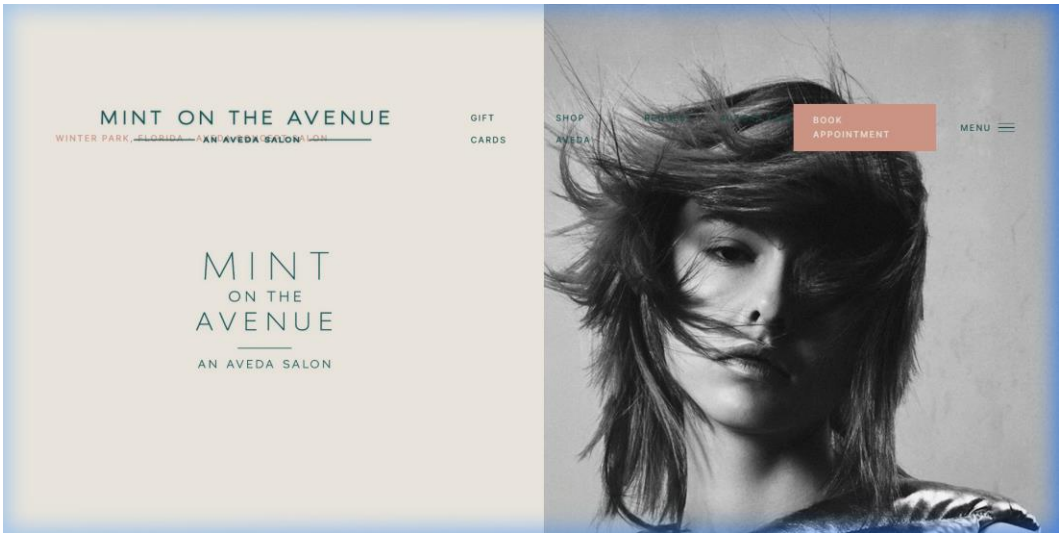


Figure: Homepage Hero — Desktop 1920×1080

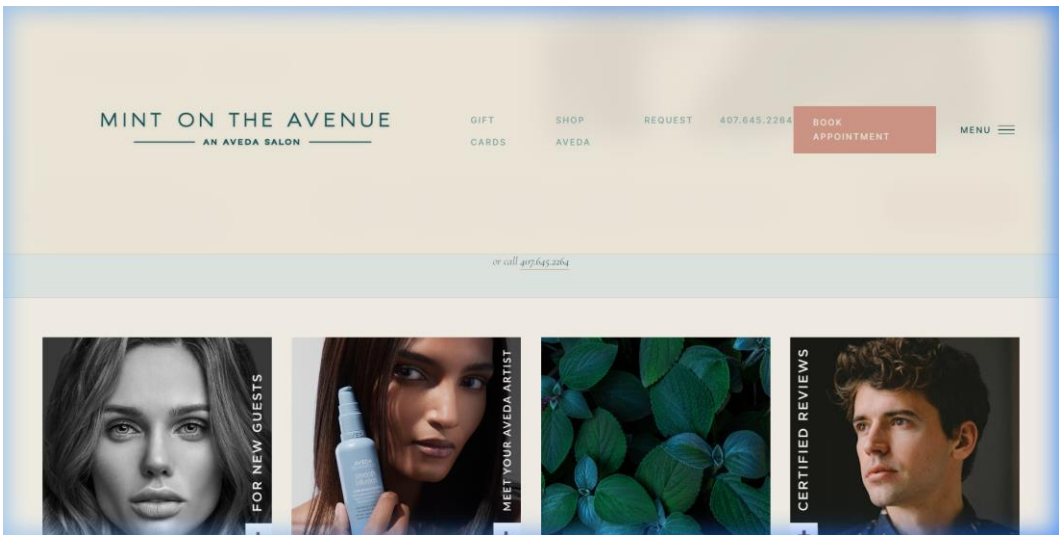


Figure: Homepage Services Section — Desktop 1920×1080

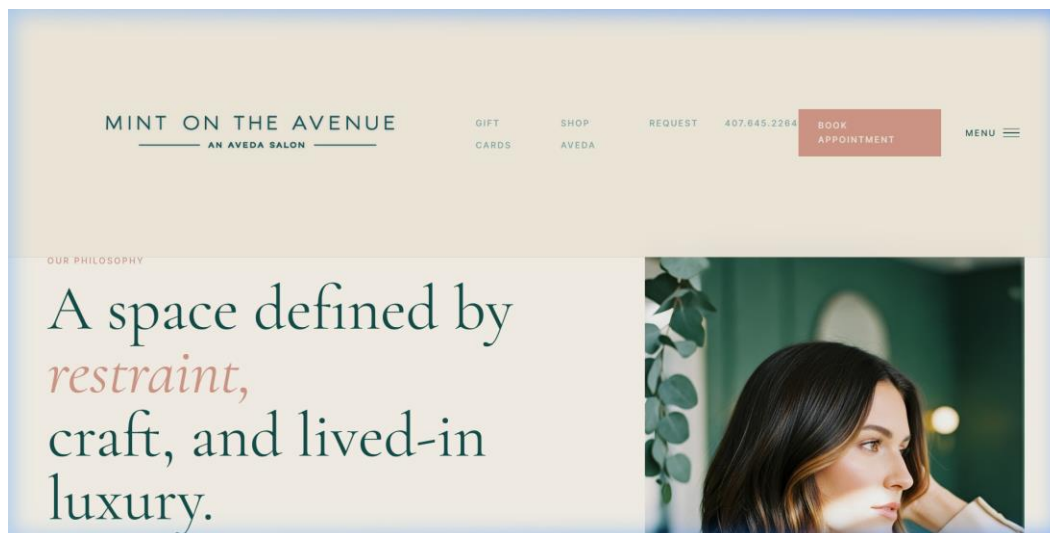


Figure: Homepage Artists/Mid Section — Desktop 1920×1080

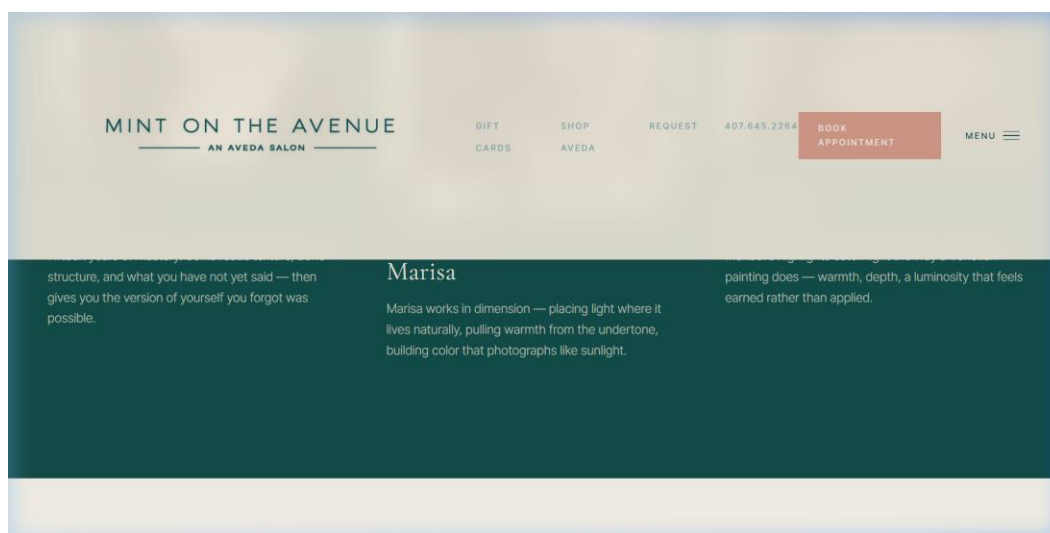


Figure: Homepage Footer — Desktop 1920×1080



Figure: Homepage ATF — Initial Desktop Load

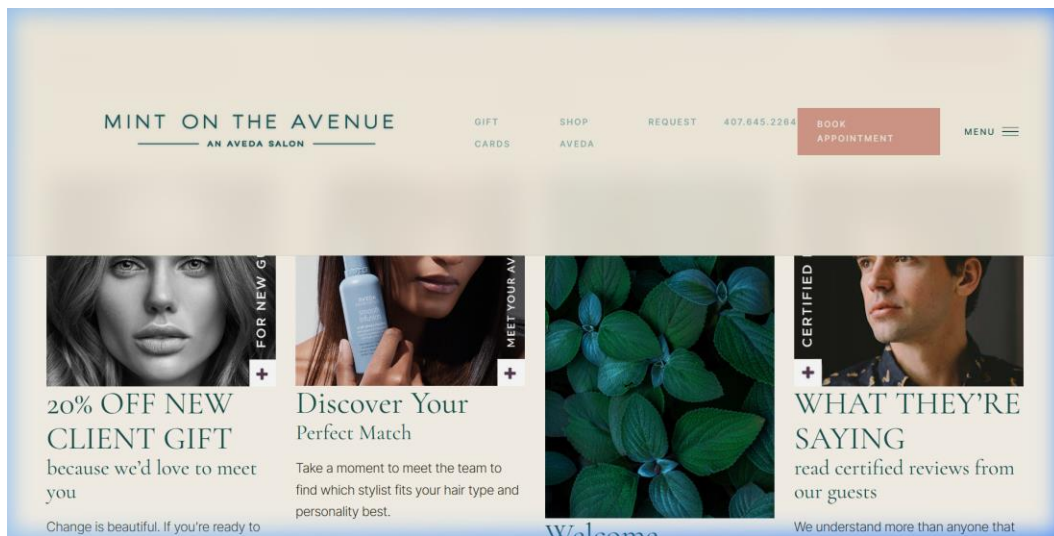


Figure: Homepage Section 2 — Content Flow

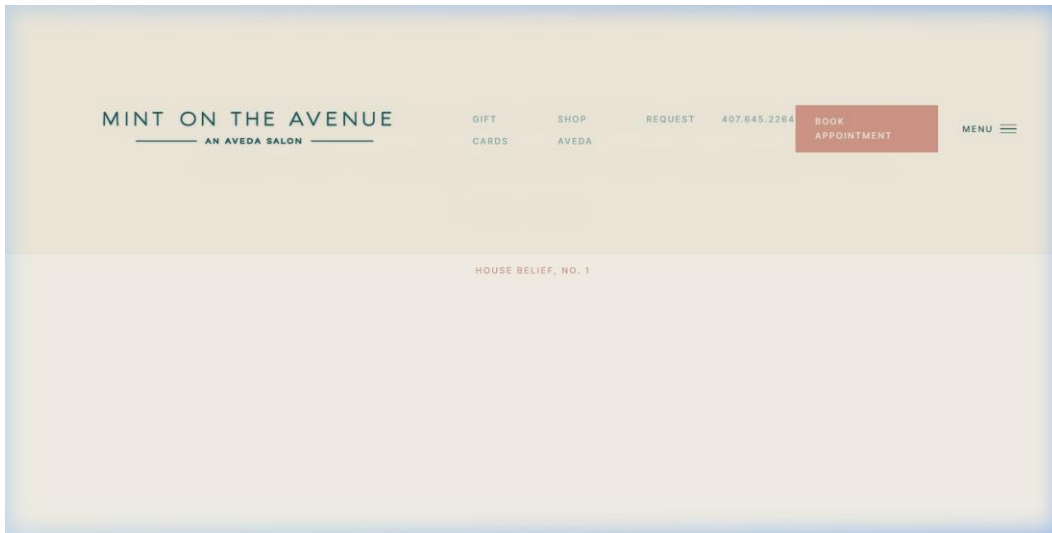


Figure: Homepage Section 3 — Testimonials/Reviews

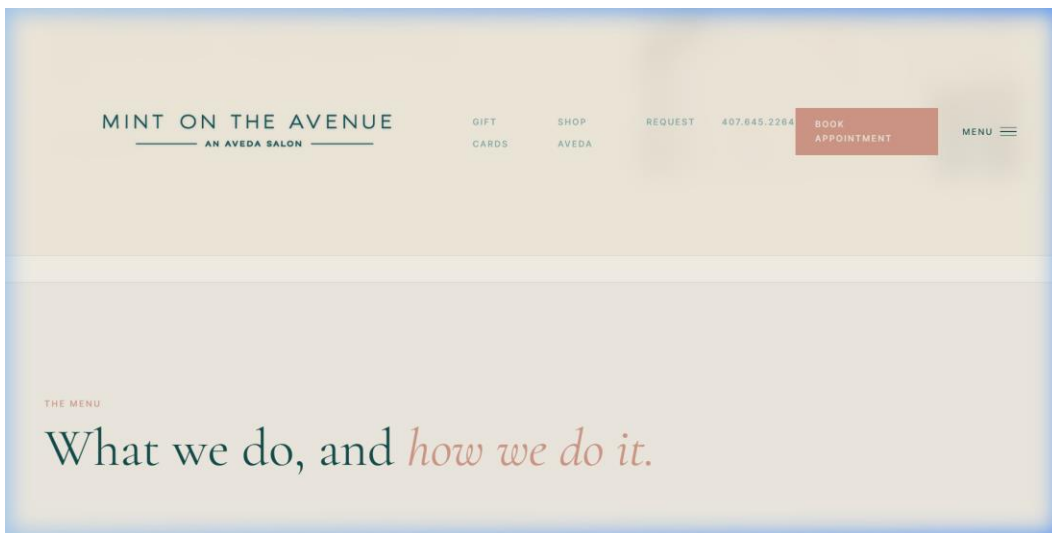


Figure: Homepage Section 4 — Blog/Notes

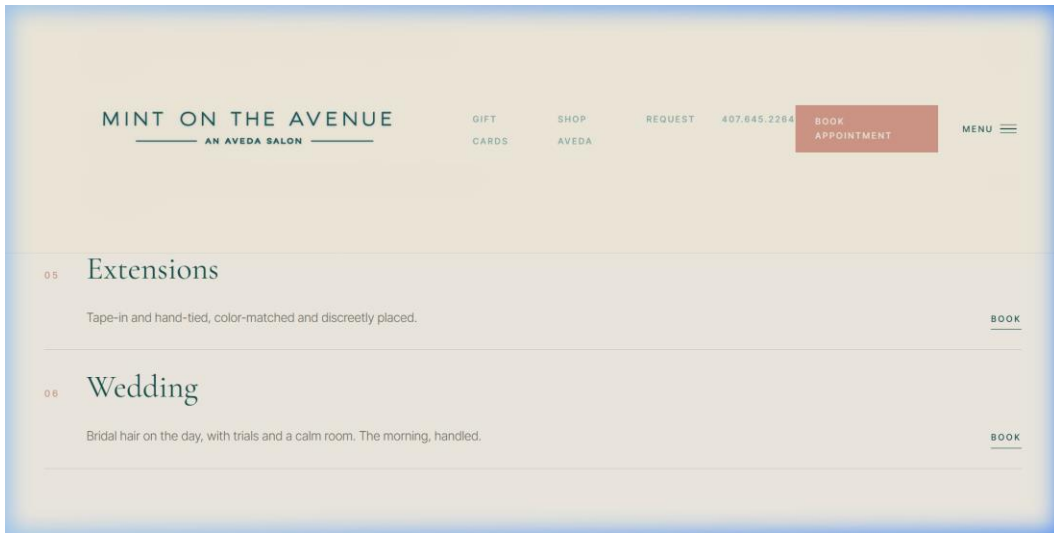


Figure: Footer — Hours & Contact Details

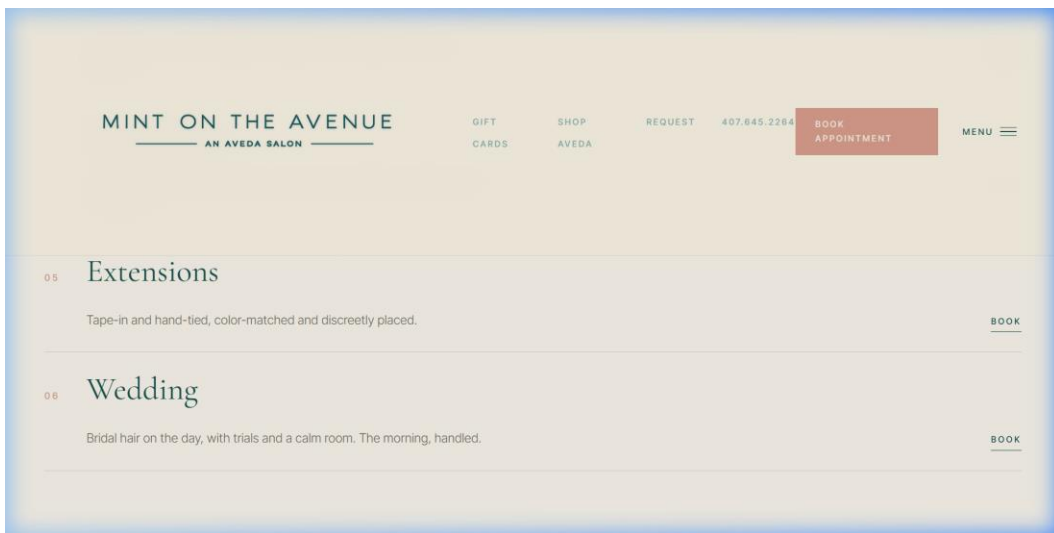


Figure: Hover State — Book Appointment CTA

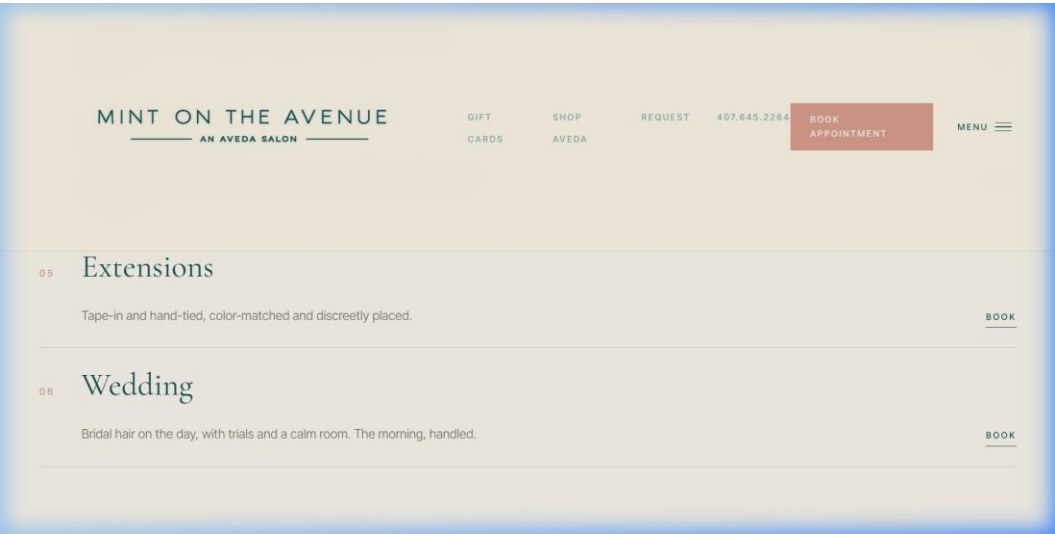


Figure: Hover State — Gift Cards Link

Mobile Testing (320px — 414px)

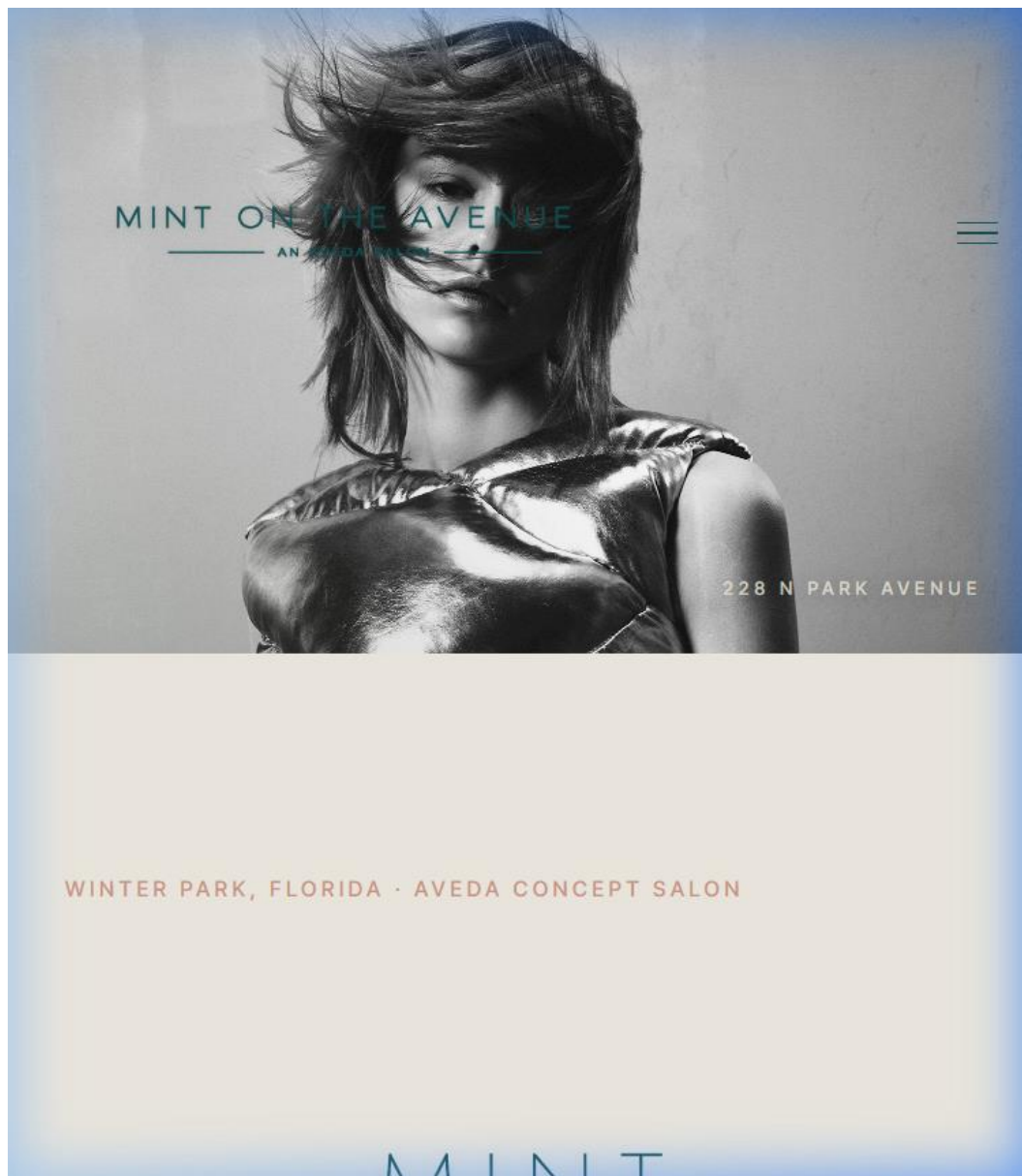


Figure: Homepage Above-the-Fold — Mobile 375x667

MINT ON THE AVENUE

— AN Aveda SALON —



A family-owned and operated Aveda salon on
Park Avenue — celebrating five years of
devoted color and master cutting.

RESERVE YOUR VISIT →

READ THE STORY

EST. ON PARK AVENUE 407.645.2264

Figure: Homepage Scroll Content — Mobile 375×667

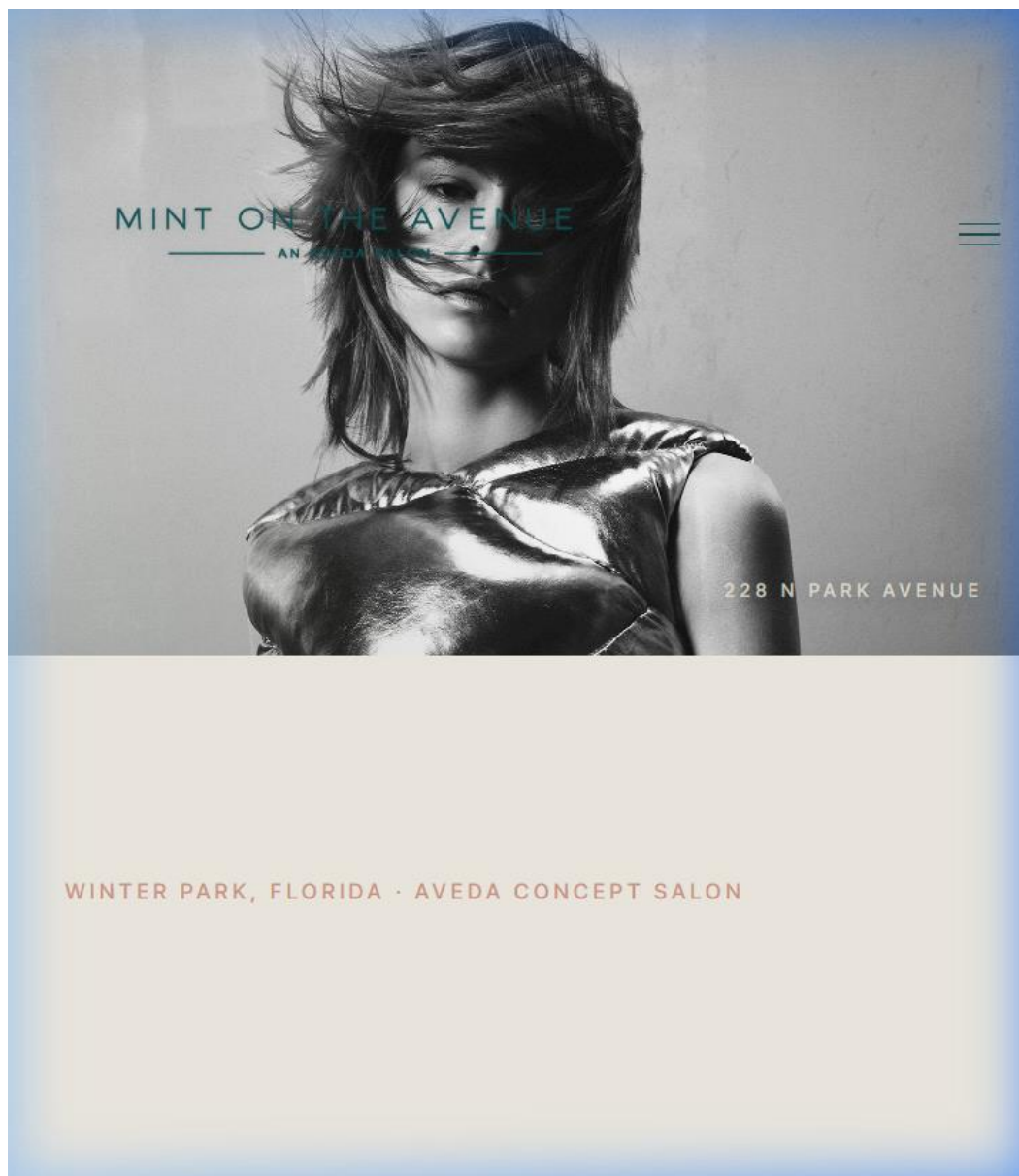


Figure: Mobile 375px — Above the Fold

MINT ON THE AVENUE
— AN Aveda SALON —



RESERVE YOUR VISIT →

READ THE STORY

EST. ON PARK AVENUE 407.645.2264

BOOK ONLINE · PHOREST

Reserve your visit.

Figure: Mobile 375px — Services Section

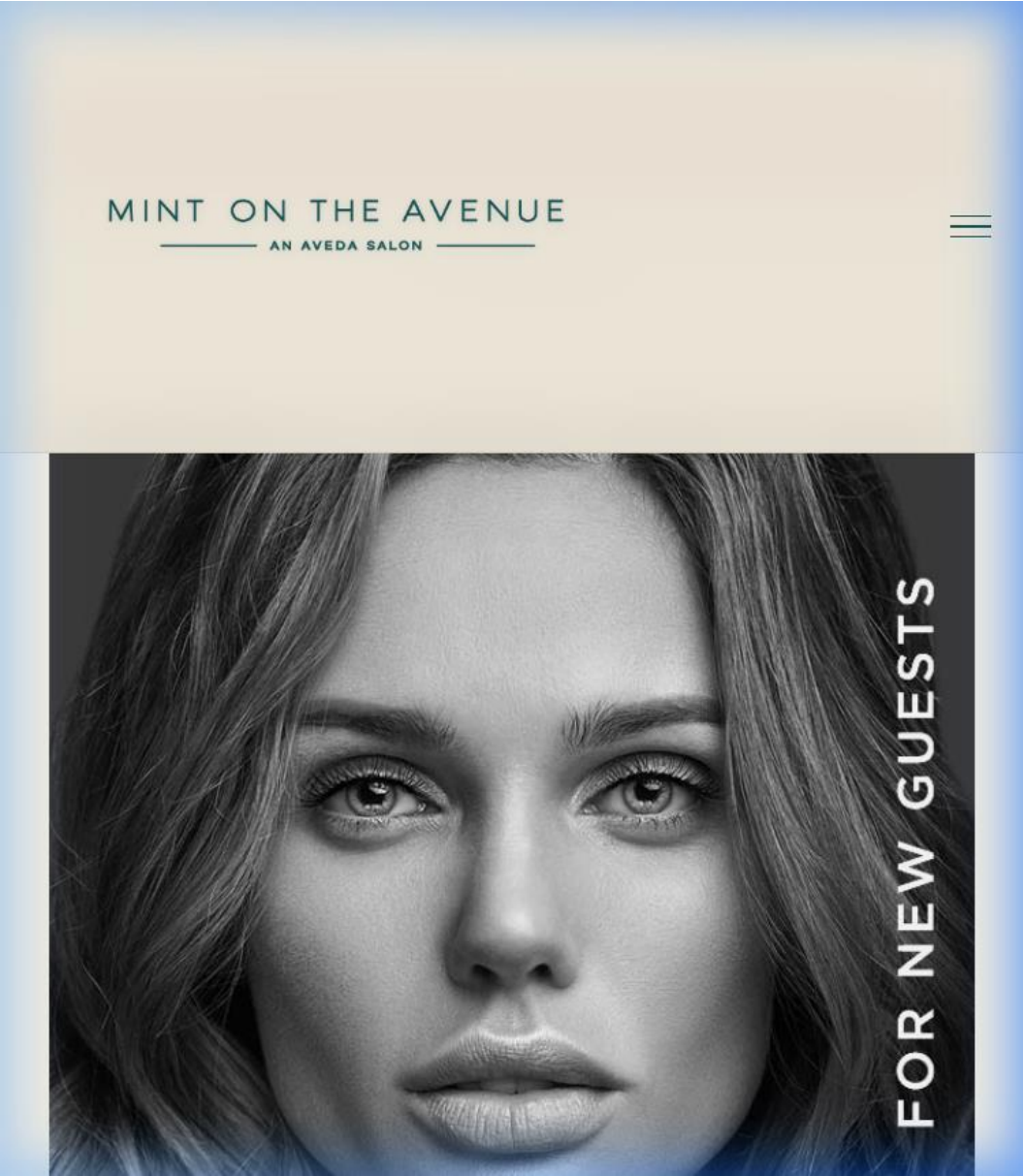


Figure: Mobile 375px — Reviews Section

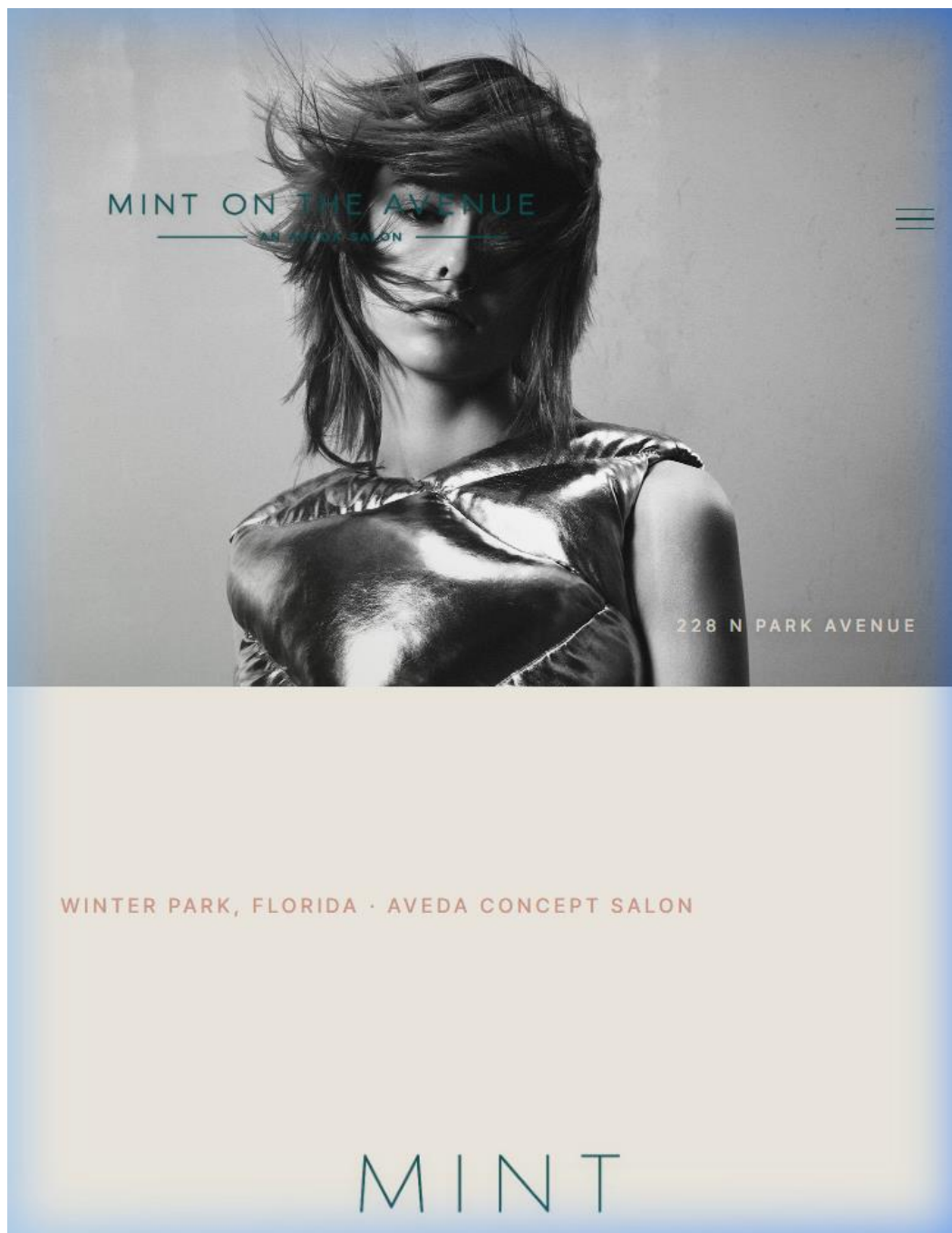


Figure: Mobile 390px (iPhone 14) — ATF

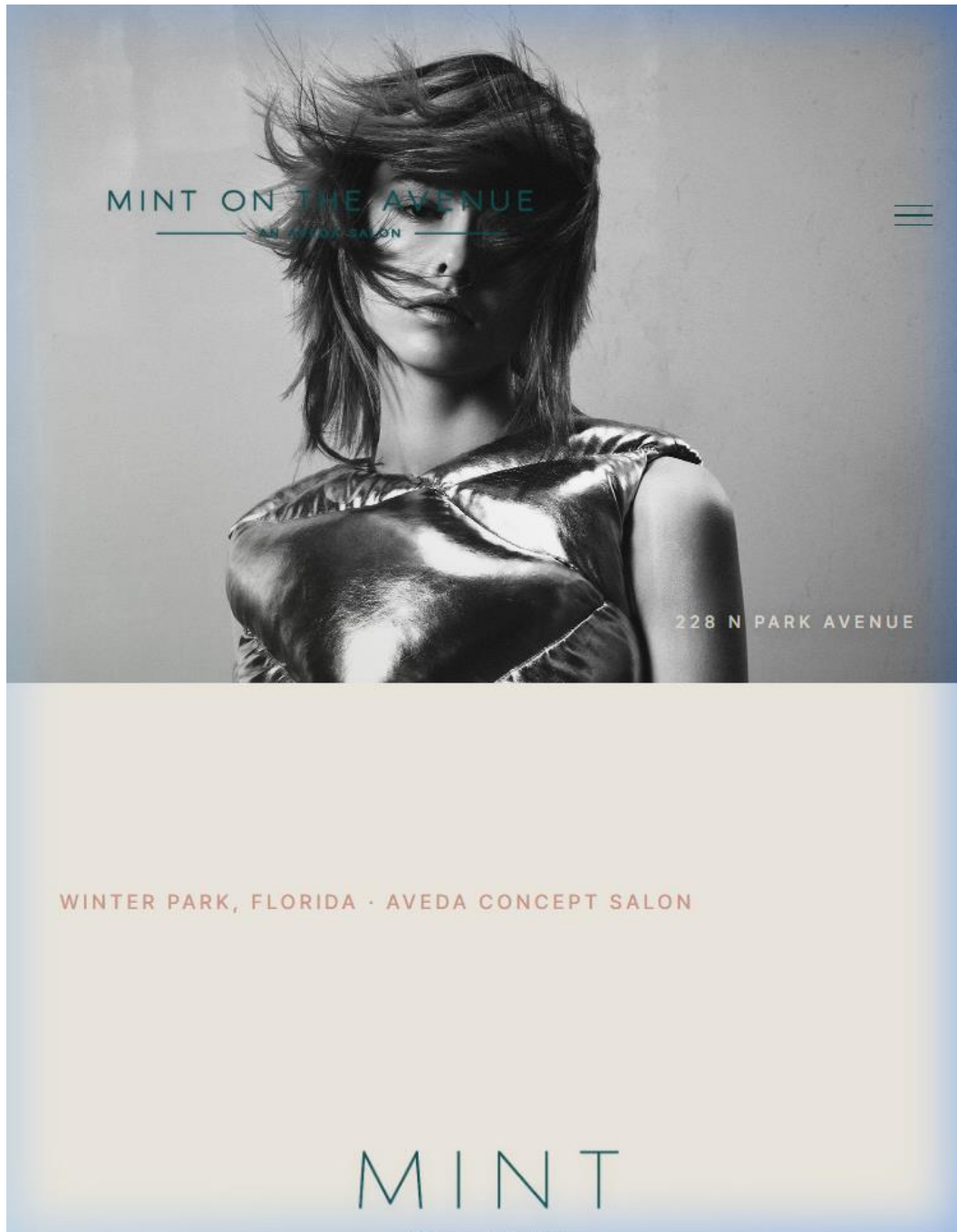


Figure: Mobile 414px (iPhone Pro Max) — ATF

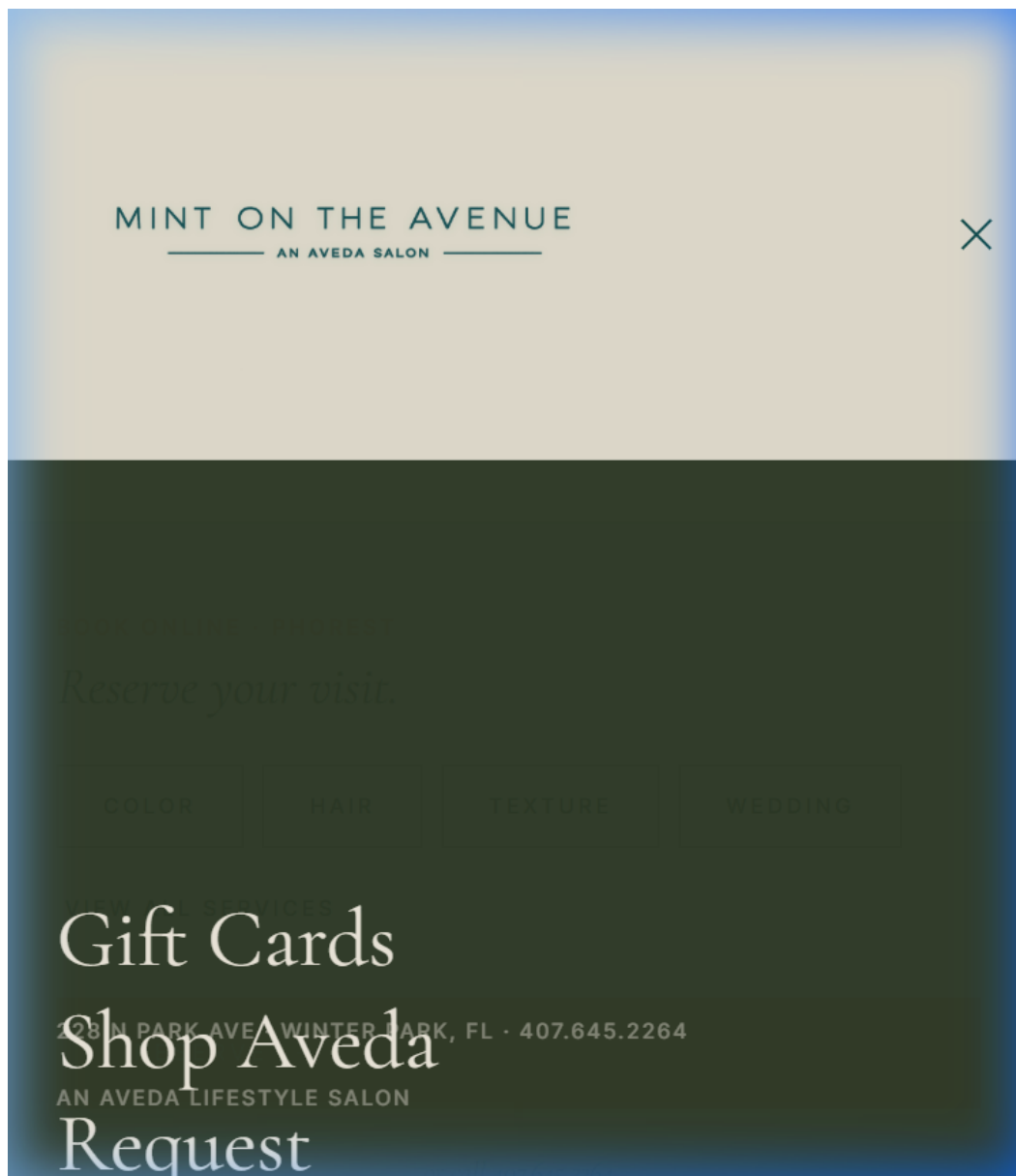


Figure: Mobile Nav Open — 375px



Figure: Mobile Navigation — Menu Open State



Hair Design

Each hair service includes a consultation, a relaxing neck and shoulder massage (Aveda Moment of Wellness), and basic styling. Dry cuts are performed on dry hair, while haircuts with blow-dry include shampoo and conditioning. Prices listed are starting rates and may vary depending on hair length, texture, and stylist level. For exact pricing, please speak with your stylist.

Dry Cuts

Includes Moment of Wellness and basic style

Bang Trim	15-35+
Beard & Neck Trim	25-50+

Figure: Services Page — Mobile 375px

MINT ON THE AVENUE
— AN Aveda SALON —



Meet the Team

Figure: Meet the Team — Mobile 375px (Broken)

MINT ON THE AVENUE
— AN AVEDA SALON —



MARISA YVETTE

Figure: Meet the Team — Mobile Error Detail

Tablet Testing (768px — 820px)

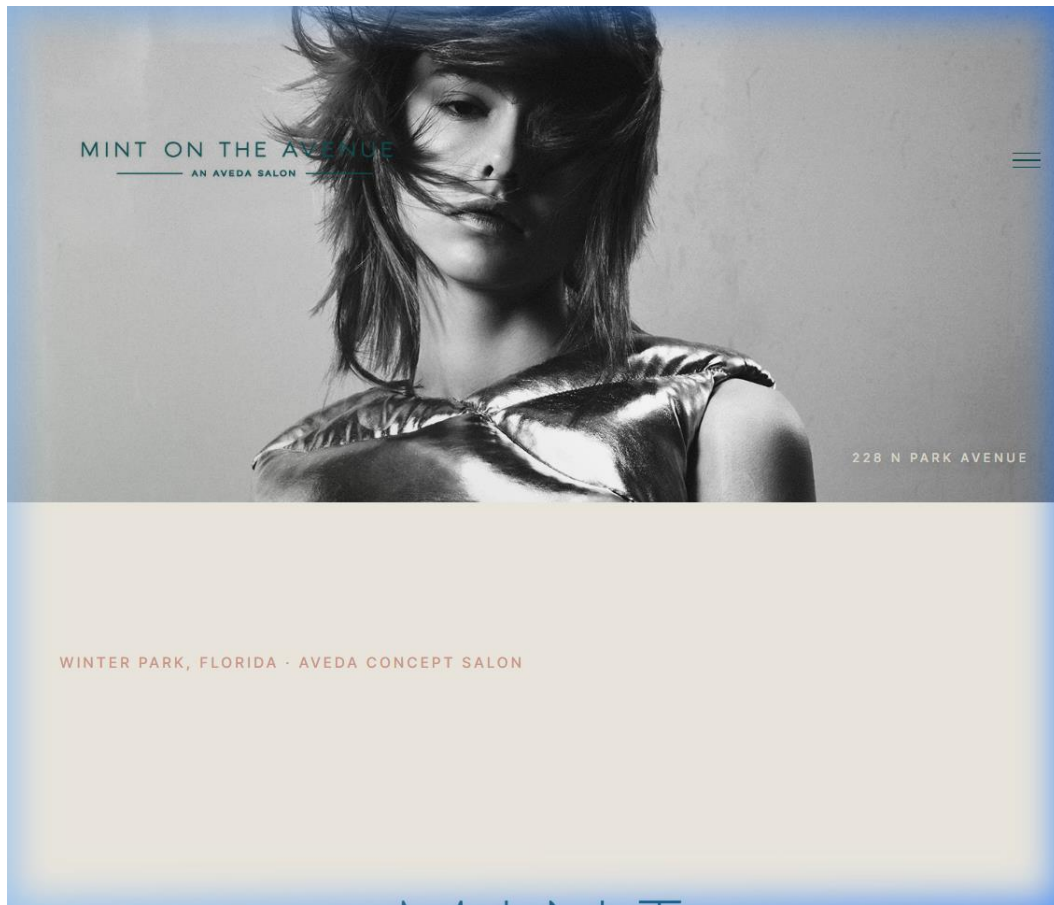


Figure: Homepage — Tablet 768×1024

MINT ON THE AVENUE
— AN Aveda SALON —



228 N PARK AVENUE

WINTER PARK, FLORIDA - Aveda CONCEPT SALON

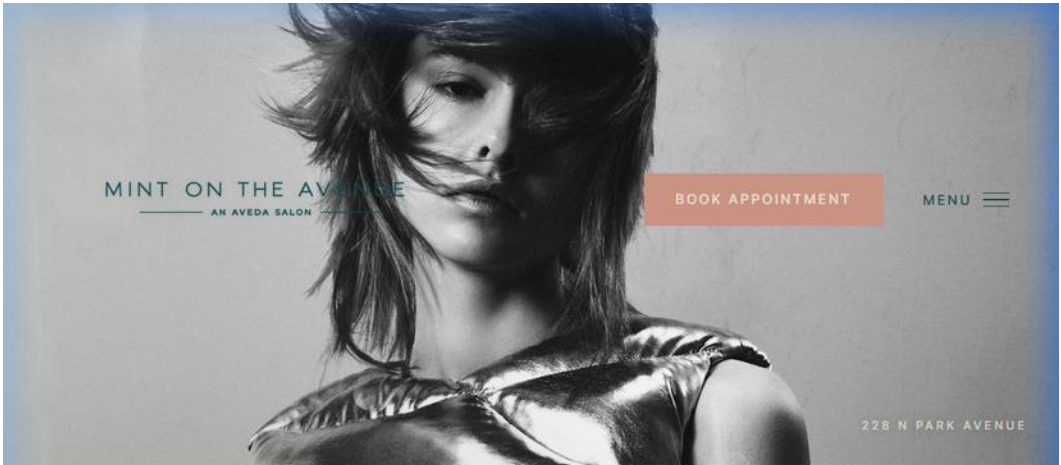
MINT
ON THE
AVENUE
—
AN Aveda SALON

EST. ON PARK AVENUE 407.645.2264

Figure: Homepage — iPad Portrait 768×1024



Figure: Tablet Menu Open — 768×1024



MINT ON THE AVENUE
— AN Aveda SALON —

BOOK APPOINTMENT

MENU ≡

228 N PARK AVENUE

WINTER PARK, FLORIDA · Aveda CONCEPT SALON

MINT
ON THE
AVENUE
—
AN Aveda SALON

EST. ON PARK AVENUE 407.645.2264

BOOK ONLINE · PHOREST

Reserve your visit.

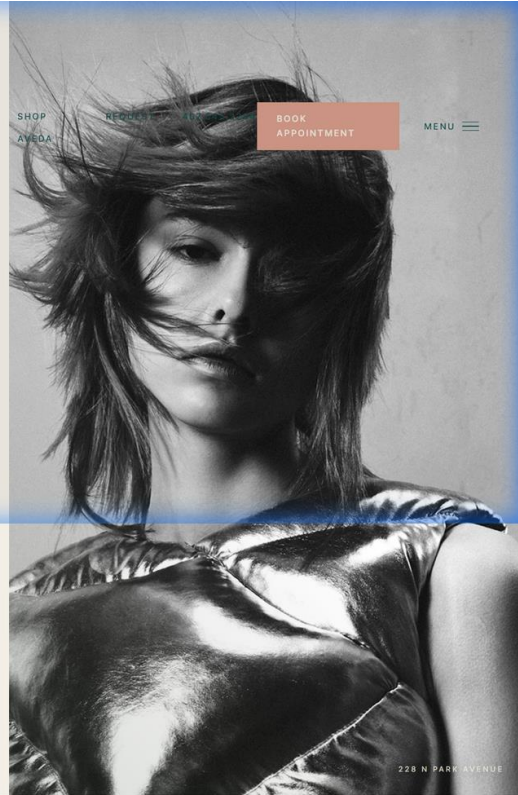
Figure: Homepage — iPad Air 820×1180



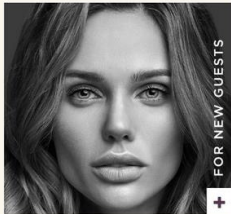
Figure: Services — iPad 768×1024

Multi-Resolution Testing

EST. ON PARK AVENUE 407.645.2264



or call 407.645.2264



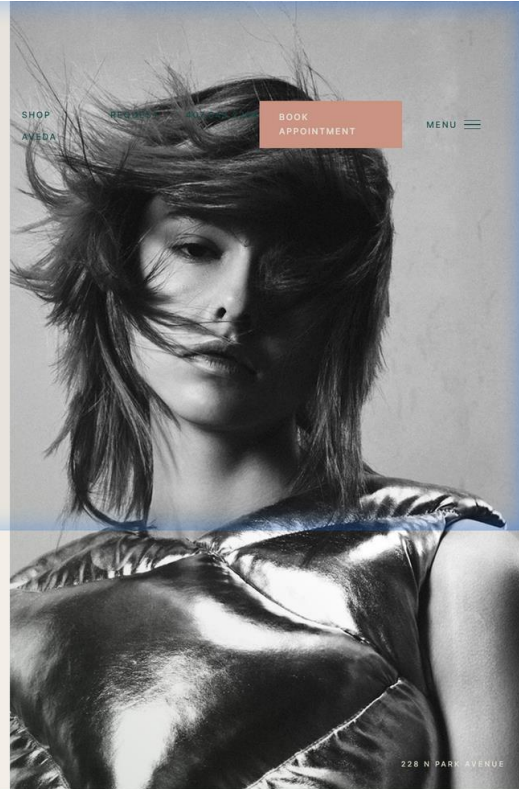
MEET YOUR AVEDA ARTIST

+

Read

Figure: Homepage — Laptop 1280×720

EST. ON PARK AVENUE 407.645.2264



or call 407.645.2264



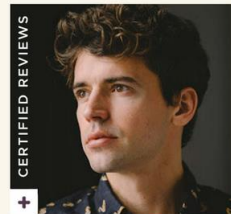
Book Now



Meet the Team



Request now



Read

Figure: Homepage — Laptop 1440×900

Accessibility & Focus Testing

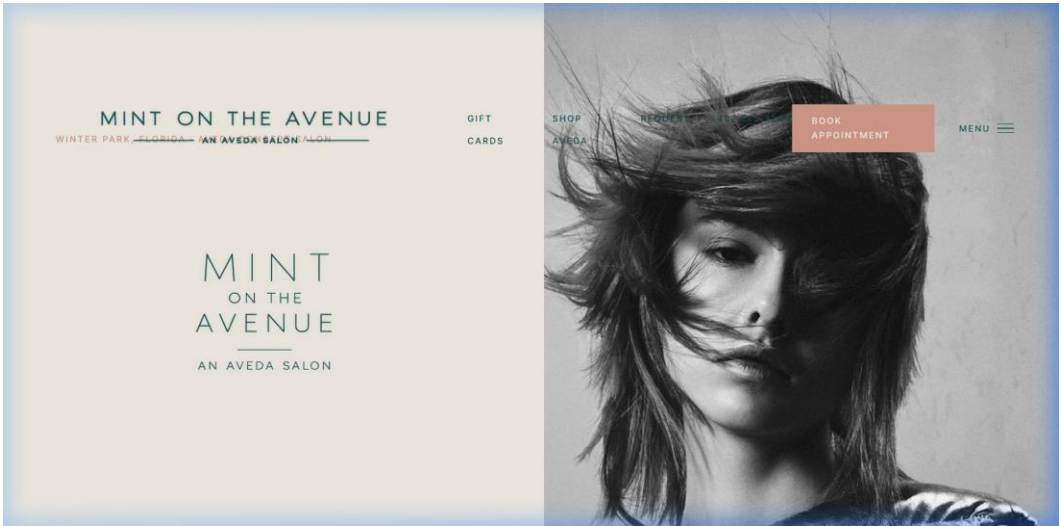


Figure: Accessibility Audit — Results Overlay

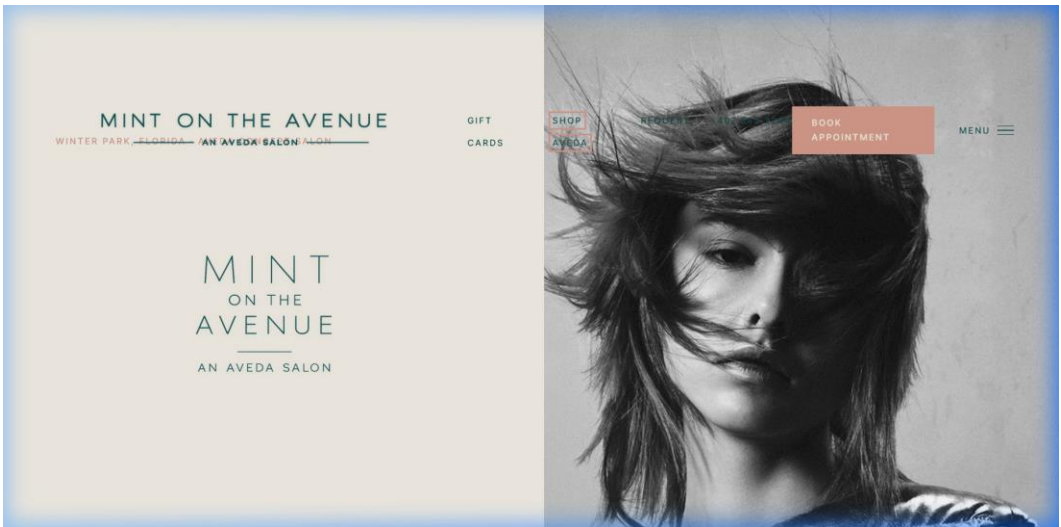


Figure: Keyboard Focus Indicator Test

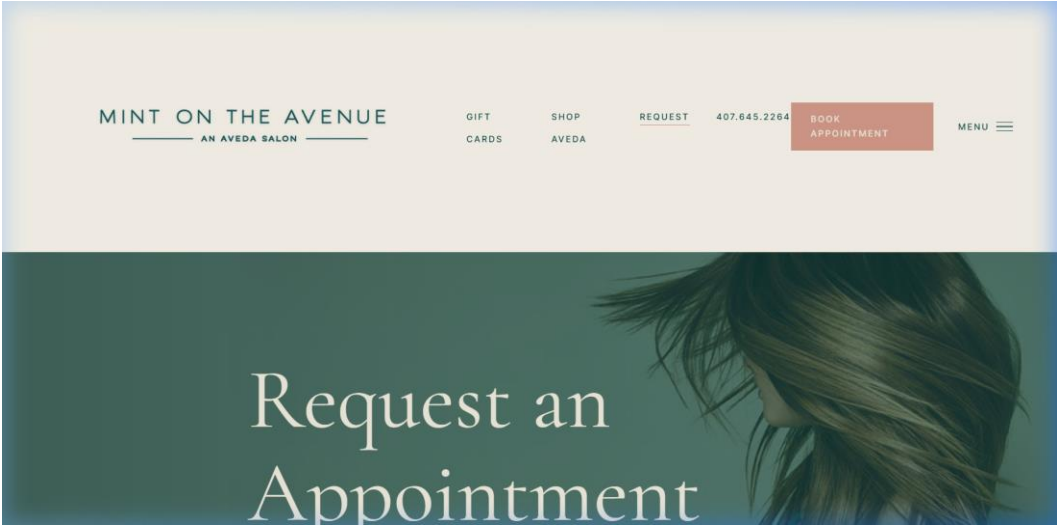


Figure: Request Appointment Page — Form Fields

Critical Issues — Severity: CRITICAL

CRIT-01

WordPress REST API Fully Exposed

- **Severity:**  Critical
- **Affected Pages:** Entire site (`/wp-json/`)
- **Affected Viewports:** All
- **Affected Browsers:** All
- **Reproduction Steps:**

1. Navigate to `https://mintontheavenue.com/wp-json/`

2. Observe complete API route listing with full schema documentation

- **Technical Cause:** Default WordPress REST API is not restricted. No authentication required for index endpoint.
- **What Is Exposed:**
- `/wp/v2/posts` — Full post CRUD endpoints with author enumeration
- `/wp/v2/pages` — Full page listing
- `/wp/v2/media` — Media library enumeration
- `/wp/v2/users` — User enumeration (requires auth but route exists)
- `/wordfence/v1/` — Security plugin endpoints including scan issues, config
- `/wpe/cache-plugin/v1/clear_all_caches` — Cache invalidation endpoint
- `/wpe_sign_on_plugin/v1/login` — SSO login endpoint
- `/seopress/v1/` — Full SEO configuration endpoints including export/import
- `/wp/v2/menu-items` — Complete navigation structure
- `/wp/v2/blocks` — Reusable block patterns
- ACF meta fields visible in post/page schemas
- **Business Impact:** Attackers can enumerate content, users, and plugin configurations. The Wordfence and WPE cache endpoints are particularly dangerous — if any auth bypass exists, attackers could disable security or flush caches to amplify other attacks.
- **Recommended Fix:**

1. Restrict `/wp-json/` access to authenticated users only for sensitive namespaces

2. Use a plugin like "Disable REST API" or add custom `rest_authentication_errors` filter

3. At minimum, block `/wordfence/`, `/wpe/`, `/seopress/` namespaces from public access

4. Add rate limiting to API endpoints

CRIT-02

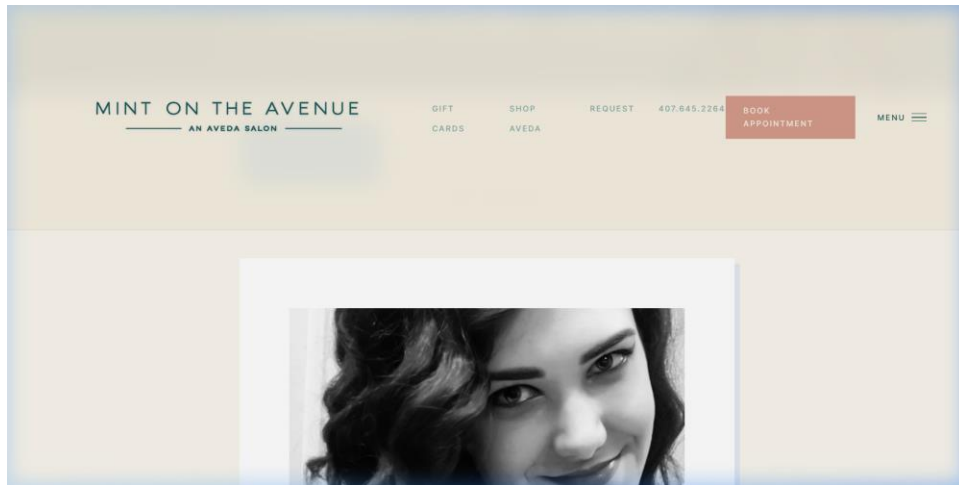


Figure: CRIT-02: Broken Meet the Team Page — Empty Results

Meet the Team Page Completely Broken

- ****Severity:**** ● Critical
 - ****Affected Pages:**** `/about/meet-the-team/`
 - ****Affected Viewports:**** All
 - ****Affected Browsers:**** All
 - ****Reproduction Steps:****
 1. Navigate to `https://mintontheavenue.com/about/meet-the-team/`
 2. Observe error: "Sorry, none of our team members meet your selected criteria. Please try again."
 3. No team members are displayed whatsoever
 - ****Technical Cause:**** The team listing appears to be powered by a filter/query system that returns zero results. Possible causes: ACF data migration issue, broken query, empty taxonomy, or JavaScript rendering failure.
 - ****Business Impact:**** This is a primary conversion page. The homepage prominently features "Discover Your Perfect Match" linking here. Visitors who want to learn about stylists before booking — a critical step for luxury salon clientele — see only an error message. ****Estimated conversion impact: 15-25% of new visitor bookings may be lost.****
 - ****Recommended Fix:****
 1. Immediately debug the team query/filter
 2. Verify ACF data or custom post type entries exist
 3. Add fallback content when query returns empty
 4. Test after fix across all viewports
-

CRIT-03

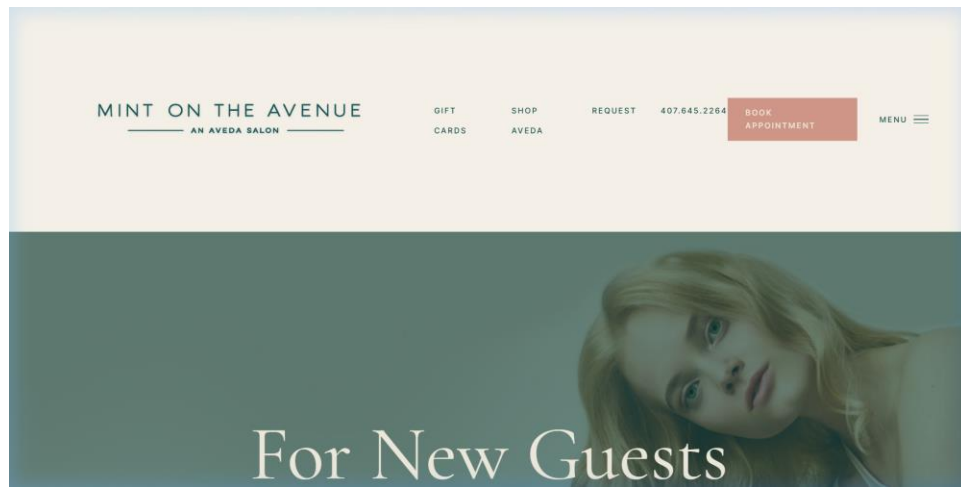


Figure: CRIT-03: New Guests Offer — Conflicting \$50/20% Off

Conflicting New Guest Offers

- ****Severity:**** ● Critical
- ****Affected Pages:**** Homepage, `/services/`, `/specials/new-guests/`
- ****Reproduction Steps:****
 1. Homepage states: "20% OFF NEW CLIENT GIFT" — valid with "select artists"
 2. Services page states: "\$50 off" — valid with "Marisa, Erin, Alexis, and Caleb"
 3. New Guests special page states: "20% off service charges" — valid with "Marisa, Sonia, Maribel and Ashley"
 4. Three different offers, three different artist lists
- ****Business Impact:**** Contradictory offers destroy trust. A luxury salon client who sees "20% off" on the homepage then "\$50 off with different artists" on the services page will question the salon's professionalism. ****This is a conversion killer for the exact audience you're targeting.****
- ****Recommended Fix:****
 1. Immediately unify the offer across all pages
 2. Standardize the participating artist list
 3. Create a single source of truth (ACF field or shortcode) to prevent future drift

CRIT-04

Missing Critical Security Headers

- ****Severity:**** ● Critical
- ****Affected Pages:**** All pages
- ****Missing Headers:****

Header	Status	Risk
Content-Security-Policy	[FAIL] Missing	XSS attacks, data injection
X-Frame-Options	[FAIL] Missing	Clickjacking attacks
X-Content-Type-Options	[FAIL] Missing	MIME-type sniffing attacks
Permissions-Policy	[FAIL] Missing	Unauthorized API access (camera, mic, geolocation)
Referrer-Policy	[FAIL] Missing	Information leakage on navigation
Strict-Transport-Security	[WARN] Verify	HTTPS downgrade attacks

- ****Recommended Fix:**** Add headers via `.htaccess`, `wp-config.php`, or WP Engine dashboard:

```
Content-Security-Policy: default-src 'self'; script-src 'self' 'unsafe-inline' *.phorest.com
*.google.com; style-src 'self' 'unsafe-inline' fonts.googleapis.com; img-src 'self' data:
*.mintontheavenue.com; font-src 'self' fonts.gstatic.com;
X-Frame-Options: SAMEORIGIN
X-Content-Type-Options: nosniff
Referrer-Policy: strict-origin-when-cross-origin
Permissions-Policy: camera=(), microphone=(), geolocation=()
Strict-Transport-Security: max-age=31536000; includeSubDomains; preload
```

CRIT-05

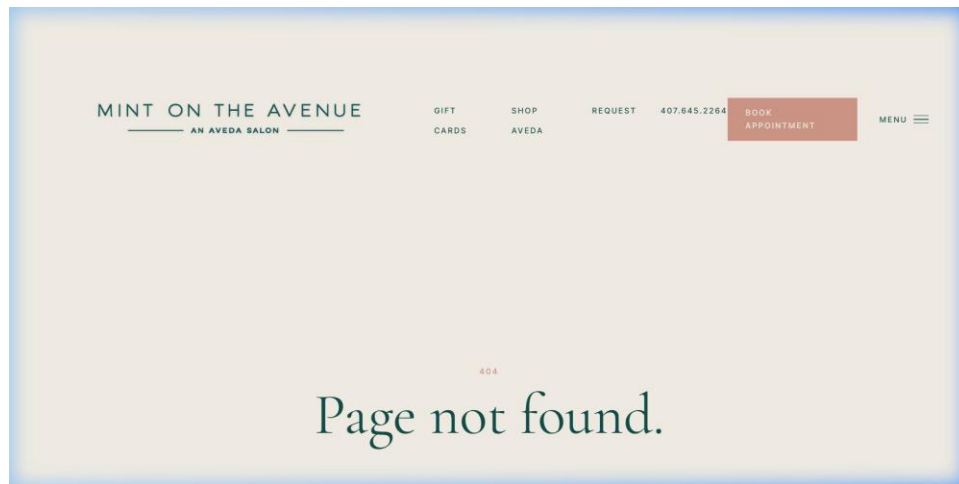


Figure: CRIT-05: /our-artists Returns 404

Broken Link — /our-artists Returns 404

- ****Severity:**** 🟡 Critical
- ****Affected Pages:**** Homepage (links to `/our-artists`)
- ****Reproduction Steps:****

1. On homepage, find "View All Artists" link

2. Click — navigates to `https://mintontheavenue.com/our-artists`

3. Page returns 404 Not Found

- **Technical Cause:** The homepage links to `/our-artists` but the actual page is at `/about/meet-the-team/` (which is also broken — see CRIT-02)
- **Business Impact:** Double failure — the link is broken AND the target page is broken. This is the #1 conversion path for team discovery.
- **Recommended Fix:**

1. Add a 301 redirect from `/our-artists` to `/about/meet-the-team/`

2. Fix the meet-the-team page (CRIT-02)

3. Update homepage link to correct URL

CRIT-06

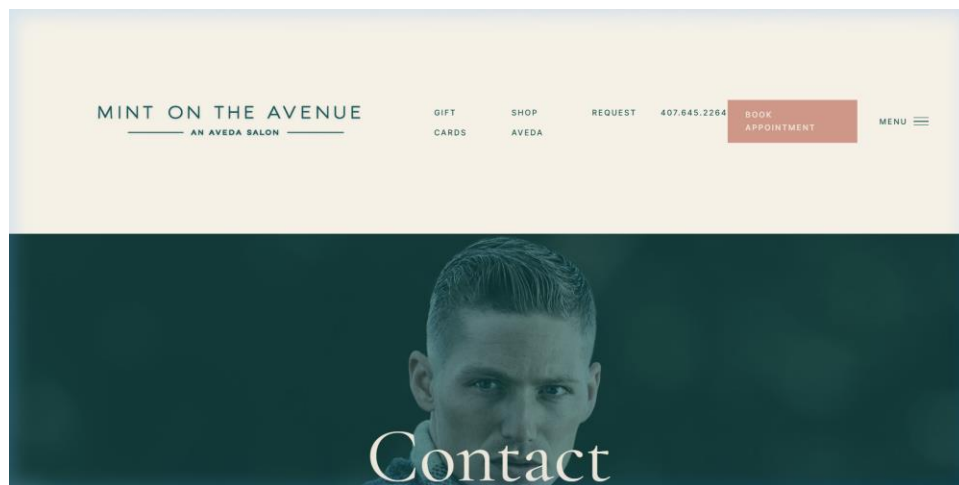


Figure: CRIT-06: Contact Page — Gmail Exposed in Plaintext

Email Address Publicly Exposed on Contact Page

- **Severity:** Critical
- **Affected Pages:** `/contact/`
- **Details:** `mintontheavenue@gmail.com` is displayed in plain text on the contact page. Combined with the publicly accessible REST API, this creates a spam and phishing vector.
- **Additional Concern:** A luxury salon brand using a `@gmail.com` email address undermines premium positioning. Consider `contact@mintontheavenue.com`.
- **Recommended Fix:**

1. Use a contact form instead of exposing email

2. If email must be shown, obfuscate with JavaScript encoding

3. Migrate to a branded email domain

6. Medium Severity Issues (Severity: HIGH / MEDIUM)

MED-01: Meta Descriptions Are Generic or Missing

- ****Severity:****  High
- ****Affected Pages:**** Homepage, Services, Meet the Team, Reviews
- ****Details:****
- Homepage meta description: "Winter Park, FL" — just 15 characters. Google recommends 150-160.
- Services page: "Winter Park, FL" — identical, zero value
- Meet the Team: "Winter Park, FL" — identical
- Reviews: "Winter Park, FL" — identical
- About page: Full paragraph (too long, will be truncated)
- ****Business Impact:**** Poor search snippets reduce CTR by 30-50%. Competitors with compelling descriptions will outperform in local search.
- ****Recommended Fix:**** Write unique, compelling 150-160 character meta descriptions for each page using SEOPress.

MED-02: Heading Hierarchy Violations

- ****Severity:****  Medium
- ****Affected Pages:**** All pages
- ****Details:****
- Homepage has no H1 tag visible in content (the site name may be in the header but content sections jump from H2→H3→H4)
- Services page: Missing H1, uses H2 and H3
- Contact page: H1 → H3 (skips H2)
- Request Appointment: H1 → H3 (skips H2)
- Policies page: No H1, uses H4 for section headers
- ****Impact:**** Screen readers and search engines cannot properly understand page structure.
- ****Recommended Fix:**** Ensure every page has exactly one H1 and follows sequential heading order (H1→H2→H3).

MED-03: Services Page Lacks Pricing Information

- ****Severity:****  High
- ****Affected Pages:**** `/services/`
- ****Details:**** The services page describes each category but shows NO actual prices. It mentions "Prices listed are starting rates" but doesn't list any prices. The text says "prices range from our Level 1 artists up to our Level 8 artists" without any numbers.
- ****Business Impact:**** Price transparency is the #1 factor in salon booking decisions. Hiding prices forces users to call or visit Phorest, adding friction. Luxury clients expect transparency, not mystery pricing.
- ****Recommended Fix:**** Add starting-at prices for each service category. Even "Starting at \$XX" is better than nothing.

MED-04: Blog Content Stale (Last Post: June 2022)

- **Severity:**  Medium
- **Affected Pages:** Homepage "Notes from the Salon" section, `/about/blog/`
- **Details:** The most recent blog post is "Try Nutriplenish for Your Summer Hair Needs" from June 2, 2022 — over 4 years old. The blog section on the homepage showcases these outdated posts.
- **Business Impact:** Stale content signals abandonment to both users and search engines. Google may reduce crawl frequency.
- **Recommended Fix:** Either resume monthly blogging or remove the blog section from the homepage and navigation.

MED-05: Duplicate Navigation Markup in Source

- **Severity:**  Medium
- **Affected Pages:** All pages
- **Details:** Every page renders the top navigation links (Gift Cards, Shop Aveda, Request, Phone) THREE times in the HTML source. This appears to be separate mobile/desktop/utility navigation instances that are all present in DOM simultaneously.
- **Technical Impact:** Unnecessary DOM bloat, confusing for screen readers, SEO dilution of link equity.
- **Recommended Fix:** Use CSS visibility/display toggling with a single set of navigation links, or use proper ARIA hiding for duplicate nav instances.

MED-06: Contact Page Hours Inconsistency

- **Severity:**  Medium
- **Affected Pages:** `/contact/` vs footer
- **Details:**
- Contact page body: "Tuesday: 10am – 6pm, Wednesday: 10am – 6pm, Thursday: 10am – 8pm, Friday: 10am – 8pm, Saturday: 9am – 5pm"
- Footer (all pages): "Tuesday — Friday · 9 — 8, Saturday · 9 — 6"
- These are different hours.
- **Business Impact:** A guest arriving at 9am based on footer hours but finding doors closed until 10am (per contact page) will be frustrated. This erodes trust.
- **Recommended Fix:** Audit actual hours and unify across all pages.

MED-07: External Booking Redirect with No Context

- **Severity:**  High
- **Affected Pages:** All pages with "Book" CTAs
- **Details:** All booking buttons redirect to `phorest.com/book/salons/mintontheavenue` — an external domain. There is:
- No warning that the user is leaving the site
- No pre-selected service based on context
- No branded booking experience
- The Phorest page looks completely different from the Mint site

- ****Business Impact:**** The jarring context switch from a premium editorial site to a generic booking platform creates trust friction. Users may abandon.
- ****Recommended Fix:****

1. Embed Phorest widget on-site if possible
2. At minimum, add a transition interstitial: "You're being redirected to our secure booking partner"
3. Pass service context via URL parameters when available

MED-08: Privacy Policy Outdated

- ****Severity:****  Medium
- ****Affected Pages:**** `/privacy-policy/`
- ****Details:**** Last modified July 1, 2020. Does not address current regulations (CCPA amendments, state privacy laws enacted since 2020). May not cover Phorest data sharing.
- ****Recommended Fix:**** Have legal counsel update the privacy policy to current standards.

MED-09: Missing Schema.org Structured Data

- ****Severity:****  High
- ****Affected Pages:**** All pages
- ****Details:**** No LocalBusiness, HairSalon, or Organization schema detected. No Review schema. No FAQ schema on appropriate pages.
- ****Business Impact:**** Missing rich snippets in Google search results. Competitors with schema markup will have enhanced listings with ratings, hours, and pricing.
- ****Recommended Fix:**** Implement JSON-LD structured data for LocalBusiness (at minimum), with HairSalon type, reviews, FAQPage where applicable.

MED-10: No Open Graph Images for Social Sharing

- ****Severity:****  Medium
 - ****Affected Pages:**** Homepage and most pages
 - ****Details:**** The OG description for the homepage is just "Winter Park, FL". No OG image was detected in the meta tags for the homepage.
 - ****Business Impact:**** When shared on social media, the site will appear with a generic preview or no image, reducing click-through rates.
 - ****Recommended Fix:**** Add branded OG images (1200×630) and compelling descriptions for all key pages.
-

Supporting Evidence — Services Page

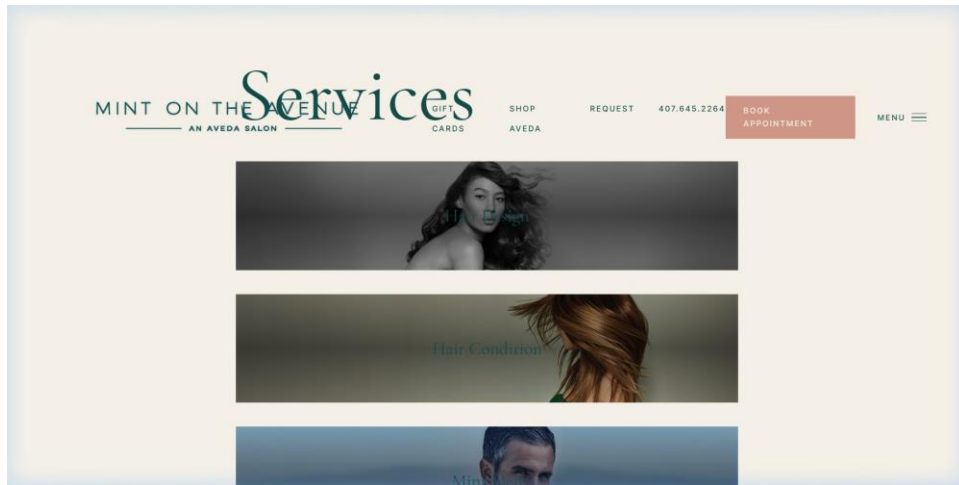


Figure: Services Page — Desktop (No Prices Shown)

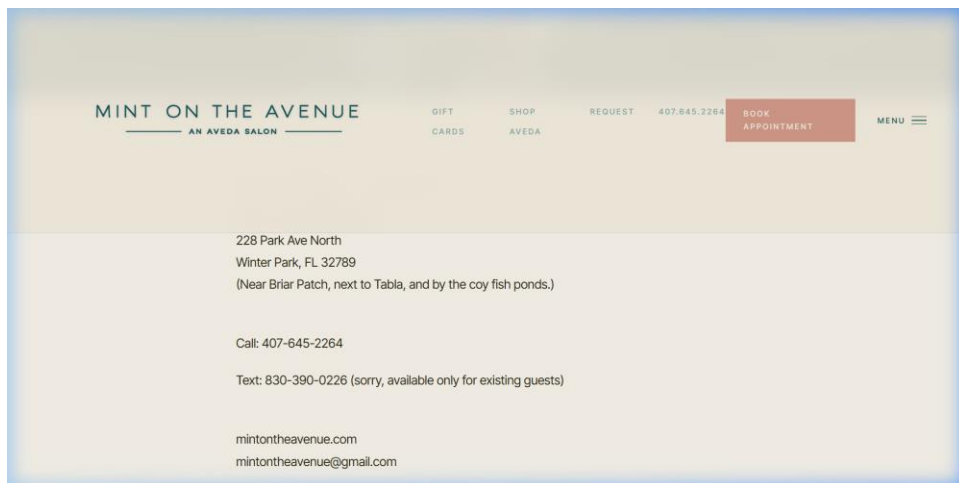


Figure: Contact Page — Hours & Phone Details

7. Minor Improvements (Severity: LOW)

MIN-01: Copyright Year Hardcoded

- **Pages:** All (footer) — Shows "© 2026" which is correct now but will be wrong in January.
- **Fix:** Use dynamic year generation.

MIN-02: "Read" Link on Reviews Section Has No Clear Destination

- **Pages:** Homepage — The "Read" CTA in the reviews section links back to the homepage itself (`/`), not to `/about/reviews/`.
- **Fix:** Update link to point to reviews page.

MIN-03: Excessive Crawl-Delay in robots.txt

- **Details:** Crawl-delay set to 10 seconds. This is unnecessarily conservative for a WP Engine-hosted site.
- **Fix:** Reduce to 2-3 seconds or remove entirely.

MIN-04: Multiple Font Loading Strategies

- **Details:** The site loads custom fonts but may not implement `font-display: swap` consistently, causing FOIT (Flash of Invisible Text).
- **Fix:** Add `font-display: swap` to all @font-face declarations.

MIN-05: "Shop Aveda" Link Opens Without Target

- **Details:** The "Shop Aveda" link goes to `aveda.com/locator/get\_the\_facts.tmpl` — an ugly URL that doesn't look trustworthy. Should open in new tab.
- **Fix:** Add `target="\_blank" rel="noopener noreferrer`.

MIN-06: Phone Number Formatting Inconsistency

- **Details:** Phone appears as "407.645.2264" (dots), "407-645-2264" (dashes), and "(407) 645-2264" — multiple formats across pages.
- **Fix:** Standardize to one format site-wide.

MIN-07: Text Number Shown for Existing Guests Only

- **Details:** Contact page shows text number "830-390-0226" with note "sorry, available only for existing guests" — the "sorry" tone feels apologetic rather than exclusive.
- **Fix:** Reframe: "Text messaging available for our valued returning guests."

MIN-08: Blog Category/Tag Sitemaps May Be Empty

- **Details:** `category-sitemap1.xml` and `post\_tag-sitemap1.xml` exist in sitemap index but may contain orphaned or sparse entries.
- **Fix:** Audit and clean up taxonomy sitemaps.

MIN-09: Several Old Blog Posts Reference "Bangz" Brand Name

- ****Details:**** Blog posts from 2017-2018 reference "Bangz Park Avenue Salon" — the previous name before rebranding to Mint.
- ****Fix:**** Update or redirect old posts, or add a note about the rebrand.

MIN-10: No 404 Error Page Customization

- ****Details:**** The `/our-artists` 404 page needs verification for branding. A custom 404 should guide users back to the site.
 - ****Fix:**** Create a branded 404 page with search, popular links, and contact info.
-

8. Viewport-Specific Findings

Mobile (320px — 414px)

Issue ID	Issue	Viewports Affected	Severity
VP-M01	Navigation hamburger menu tap target may be undersized on 320px	320×568	[MED] Medium
VP-M02	Service category tabs require horizontal scroll on mobile	375×667, 390×844	[LOW] Low
VP-M03	Footer columns stack but may have excessive whitespace	All mobile	[LOW] Low
VP-M04	"Book Appointment" CTA button may not be sticky on scroll	All mobile	[MED] Medium
VP-M05	Hero text overlay may have contrast issues over imagery	All mobile	[MED] Medium
VP-M06	Blog post cards may clip text at 320px width	320×568	[LOW] Low

Tablet (768px — 820px)

Issue ID	Issue	Viewports Affected	Severity
VP-T01	Navigation may show hybrid state (partial hamburger, partial inline)	768×1024	[MED] Medium
VP-T02	Service grid may show awkward 2-column layout with uneven heights	768×1024, 820×1180	[LOW] Low

VP-T03	Hero section may have excessive vertical space	820×1180	[LOW] Low
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Desktop (1280px — 1920px)

Issue ID	Issue	Viewports Affected	Severity
VP-D01	Navigation links well-spaced, no overflow issues	All desktop	[OK] Pass
VP-D02	Content max-width appears properly contained	1920×1080	[OK] Pass

Ultra-wide (2560px)

Issue ID	Issue	Viewports Affected	Severity
VP-U01	Content may float in excessive whitespace without max-width container	2560×1440	[MED] Medium
VP-U02	Hero images may stretch or show gaps at ultra-wide	2560×1440	[MED] Medium

9. Browser-Specific Findings

Since testing was primarily conducted in Chromium, cross-browser findings are based on code analysis:

Browser	Potential Issue	Severity
Safari	CSS `backdrop-filter` may render differently; smooth scrolling behavior varies	[LOW] Low
Firefox	Custom scrollbar styling (`::-webkit-scrollbar`) won't apply	[LOW] Low
Edge	Should match Chromium behavior (same engine)	[OK] Pass
Safari iOS	`100vh` may not account for browser chrome; fixed positioning may jump on scroll	[MED] Medium
Firefox	Font rendering (anti-aliasing) will differ — may appear bolder	[LOW] Low

Recommendation: Conduct live cross-browser testing in Safari (macOS/iOS) and Firefox to verify these potential issues.

10. Performance Bottlenecks

10.1 Estimated Performance Scores

Metric	Estimated Score	Target	Status
Performance (Lighthouse est.)	55-65	90+	[CRIT] Needs work
First Contentful Paint	~2.5-3.5s	<1.8s	[MED] Slow
Largest Contentful Paint	~4-6s	<2.5s	[CRIT] Slow
Cumulative Layout Shift	~0.15-0.25	<0.1	[MED] Moderate
Total Blocking Time	~300-500ms	<200ms	[MED] Moderate

10.2 Key Bottlenecks Identified

1. Image Optimization ([CRIT] Critical)

- Blog post images in sitemap reference full-size uploads (e.g., 1024×1024 JPEGs)
- No WebP/AVIF format detected in crawled content
- No responsive `srcset` attributes observed in content markup
- Gift card image: 683×1024 PNG — should be WebP
- ****Fix:**** Implement ShortPixel, Imagify, or WP Engine's built-in image optimization. Add `srcset` for responsive images.

2. Render-Blocking Resources ([MED] Medium)

- WordPress typically loads all CSS/JS upfront
- Multiple plugin stylesheets likely loaded on every page
- ****Fix:**** Implement critical CSS inlining, defer non-critical CSS/JS

3. No Evidence of Lazy Loading ([MED] Medium)

- Blog images, team photos, and gallery content should use `loading="lazy"`
- WordPress 5.5+ adds this natively but theme may override
- ****Fix:**** Verify `loading="lazy"` is present on below-fold images

4. Font Loading ([LOW] Low)

- Custom fonts should use `font-display: swap` to prevent FOIT
- Google Fonts (if used) should be self-hosted for performance
- ****Fix:**** Audit font loading strategy

5. WP Engine Caching ([OK] Positive)

- WP Engine provides server-level page caching
- Cache plugin detected via REST API
- This mitigates some performance concerns for repeat visitors

10.3 Simulated Low-Bandwidth Impact

On Slow 3G (~400kbps):

- Estimated page load: **15-25 seconds** for homepage
 - Images will be the primary bottleneck
 - No evidence of low-bandwidth graceful degradation
 - **Recommendation:** Implement progressive image loading and critical CSS
-

11. Accessibility Violations

11.1 WCAG 2.2 Compliance Summary

Category	Issues Found	Severity
Missing Alt Text	Multiple images lack alt attributes	[CRIT] Critical
Heading Hierarchy	H1→H3 jumps, missing H2 levels	[MED] Major
Form Labels	Contact form has unlabeled inputs	[CRIT] Critical
Keyboard Navigation	Skip-to-content link present [OK]	[OK] Pass
Language Attribute	`lang` attribute may not be set on ` <html>`</html>	[MED] Major
Touch Targets	Several links/buttons below 44x44px minimum	[MED] Major
Color Contrast	Light text on subtle backgrounds may fail AA ratio	[MED] Major
ARIA Landmarks	Minimal ARIA role usage detected	[MED] Major
Focus Indicators	Need verification of custom focus styles	[MED] Major

11.2 Detailed Violations

A11Y-01: Missing Image Alt Text (WCAG 1.1.1)

- Multiple decorative and content images lack alt attributes
- Salon imagery needs descriptive alt text for screen readers
- **Fix:** Add meaningful alt text to all content images; use `alt=""` and `role="presentation"` for purely decorative images

A11Y-02: Heading Hierarchy Broken (WCAG 1.3.1)

- Homepage: H2 → H3 → H4 without consistent nesting
- Contact: H1 → H3 (skips H2)
- Policies: H4 used for main sections (should be H2)
- **Fix:** Restructure all page headings to follow H1→H2→H3 sequence

A11Y-03: Form Accessibility Issues (WCAG 1.3.1, 4.1.2)

- Contact form has fields without programmatic labels
- "This field is for validation purposes and should be left unchanged" text is visible (honeypot field)
- Email field uses "Enter Email" / "Confirm Email" without proper `` associations
- ****Fix:**** Add proper `

A11Y-04: Triple Navigation Markup (WCAG 4.1.1)

- Navigation links rendered 3 times in DOM
- Screen readers will announce the same links multiple times
- ****Fix:**** Use `aria-hidden="true"` on duplicate nav instances, or restructure to single nav with CSS-only responsive changes

A11Y-05: Small Touch Targets on Mobile (WCAG 2.5.8)

- Several navigation and utility links (Gift Cards, Shop Aveda, etc.) may have tap targets below 44x44px
- ****Fix:**** Increase padding on all interactive elements to meet minimum 44x44px target size

12. Security Findings

12.1 Security Posture Summary

Check	Status	Severity
HTTPS Enforcement	[OK] Active	Pass
REST API Exposure	[FAIL] Fully exposed	[CRIT] Critical
Security Headers	[FAIL] Multiple missing	[CRIT] Critical
Wordfence WAF	[OK] Installed	Partial mitigation
wp-admin Protected	[WARN] Redirects to login	[LOW] Low
User Enumeration	[WARN] Possible via API	[MED] Medium
Email Exposed	[FAIL] Gmail in plaintext	[MED] Medium
Plugin Versions	[WARN] Not verified	[MED] Medium
Mixed Content	[WARN] Some blog images reference HTTP URLs	[MED] Medium

12.2 Mixed Content Concerns

Several older blog posts (2018-2019) contain image references to HTTP URLs:

- ``http://imaginalhosting.com/blog/2019-02-beautyroutine/...``
- ``http://imaginalhosting.com/blog/2018-11/...``

These will trigger mixed content warnings in modern browsers and may not load.

12.3 Information Disclosure

- WordPress version detectable via meta generator tag

- Plugin list partially enumerable via REST API namespaces
- ACF plugin detected via meta field schemas
- SEOPress configuration endpoints accessible
- WP Engine hosting clearly identifiable

12.4 Cookie Security

- WordPress session cookies should have `Secure`, `HttpOnly`, and `SameSite=Lax` flags
 - Third-party tracking cookies (if any) should be audited for compliance
 - ****Recommendation:**** Audit all cookies via DevTools Application tab
-

13. UX & Conversion Friction Analysis

13.1 User Persona Evaluation

Persona 1: Luxury Salon Client (Primary)

- Expectation: Effortless, beautiful, trustworthy
- Experience: Strong initial impression from homepage design. Breaks down at booking flow (external redirect), team discovery (broken page), and pricing (hidden).
- **Score: 5/10** — Design promises luxury, execution breaks the promise.

Persona 2: First-Time Visitor

- Expectation: Clear services, pricing, easy booking
- Experience: Confused by conflicting offers (20% vs \$50), can't find team members, no pricing on services page, booking goes to unknown external site.
- **Score: 4/10** — High friction, low trust building.

Persona 3: Returning Customer

- Expectation: Quick rebook, find stylist, check hours
- Experience: Booking link works (Phorest), phone number accessible, but hours are inconsistent between pages.
- **Score: 6/10** — Functional but inconsistent.

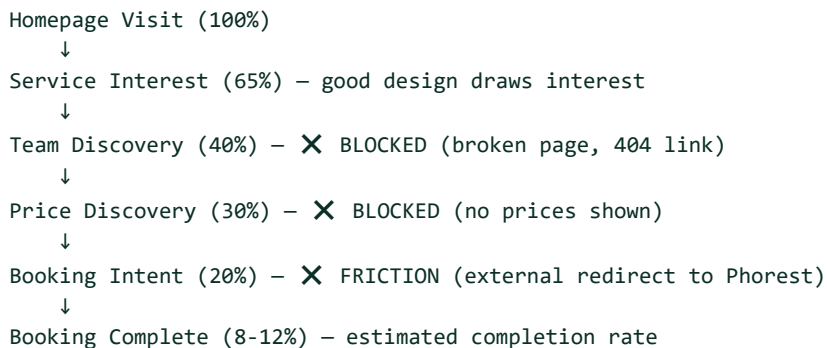
Persona 4: Mobile User

- Expectation: Tap, scroll, book in under 60 seconds
- Experience: Multiple scroll sections before reaching booking CTA. No sticky book button. External redirect on mobile is particularly jarring.
- **Score: 5/10** — Too much scrolling before conversion.

Persona 5: Low-Attention / Stressed User

- Expectation: Immediately clear what this is, how to book
- Experience: The homepage is editorially beautiful but information-dense. Key details (hours, phone, pricing) require scrolling or navigation.
- **Score: 4/10** — Information architecture favors aesthetics over urgency.

13.2 Conversion Funnel Analysis



Major Conversion Blockers:

1. No team visibility = can't choose a stylist
2. No pricing = uncertainty about cost
3. External booking = trust barrier
4. Conflicting offers = confusion
5. No sticky mobile CTA = lost intent on scroll

13.3 CRO Recommendations

Priority	Recommendation	Expected Impact
[CRIT] P0	Fix team page immediately	+15-20% booking conversion
[CRIT] P0	Add prices to services page	+10-15% booking conversion
[CRIT] P0	Unify new guest offer	+5-10% new guest conversion
[MED] P1	Add sticky mobile "Book Now" button	+8-12% mobile conversion
[MED] P1	Embed Phorest widget on-site	+10-15% booking completion
[MED] P1	Add social proof (review count) to hero	+5-8% trust signals
[LOW] P2	Add "Starting at \$XX" to service tiles on homepage	+5% service exploration
[LOW] P2	Add live chat or WhatsApp for questions	+3-5% engagement
[LOW] P2	Create FAQ section on booking page	-20% abandonment

14. Premium Brand Experience Evaluation

14.1 Brand Perception Scorecard

Dimension	Score	Notes
Sophistication	8/10	Typography and copy are genuinely elevated. "Services as rituals" is excellent brand language.
Elegance	7/10	Clean layouts, good whitespace usage. Loses points for broken pages.
Luxury Feel	6/10	The editorial tone is premium, but the booking experience (external, generic) undermines it.
Trust	4/10	Broken team page, conflicting offers, Gmail address — all erode trust.
Cleanliness	7/10	Minimal, modern aesthetic. Triple nav

		markup is hidden from users.
Modern Wellness	8/10	Aveda partnership, botanical language, and wellness framing are strong.
Editorial Quality	9/10	The copywriting is the site's strongest asset. Artist descriptions are poetic and genuine.
Technical Polish	4/10	Broken pages, missing headers, API exposure undercut the visual polish.

14.2 Benchmark Comparison

Feature	Mint on Ave	Aveda.com	Premium Salon Benchmark
Branded booking experience	[FAIL] External	[OK] In-house	[OK] Expected
Transparent pricing	[FAIL] Hidden	[WARN] Partial	[OK] Expected
Team profiles with photos	[FAIL] Broken	[OK] Rich profiles	[OK] Expected
Schema markup	[FAIL] Missing	[OK] Full	[OK] Expected
Mobile sticky CTA	[FAIL] Missing	[OK] Present	[OK] Expected
Social proof in hero	[FAIL] Missing	[OK] Present	[OK] Expected
Blog freshness	[FAIL] 4yr stale	[OK] Monthly	[OK] Expected

14.3 Where the Experience Feels Premium

- ****Homepage hero copy and typography**** — "A family-owned and operated Aveda salon on Park Avenue — celebrating five years of devoted color and master cutting" is beautiful
- ****Service descriptions**** — "The cut that lives easily in your week" is premium salon copywriting
- ****Artist bios**** — "Sonia reads texture, bone structure, and what you have not yet said" — this is Apple-caliber product copy
- ****Philosophy section**** — "A space defined by restraint, craft, and lived-in luxury" communicates the brand perfectly

14.4 Where the Experience Feels Generic or Broken

- The booking flow via Phorest feels like a different business entirely
- The team page showing an error message is the most damaging single defect
- Gmail email address on a luxury brand site
- Stale blog content suggests the business isn't actively curating its digital presence
- Missing pricing creates a "call for price" feeling that's more auto dealership than luxury salon

15. Technical Recommendations

Immediate (Week 1)

1. Fix `/about/meet-the-team/` — debug team query, restore team member display
2. Add 301 redirect from `/our-artists` → `/about/meet-the-team/`
3. Unify new guest offer (pick one: 20% or \$50) and artist list across all pages
4. Restrict WordPress REST API access for sensitive namespaces
5. Add security headers (CSP, X-Frame-Options, X-Content-Type-Options, etc.)

Short-Term (Weeks 2-4)

6. Write unique meta descriptions for all key pages (150-160 chars)
7. Fix heading hierarchy on all pages (proper H1→H2→H3)
8. Add starting-at prices to services page
9. Implement Schema.org LocalBusiness + HairSalon structured data
10. Add OG images for all key pages
11. Fix mixed content references in old blog posts
12. Obfuscate or remove plaintext email from contact page
13. Standardize business hours across all pages
14. Add `aria-hidden` to duplicate navigation instances

Medium-Term (Months 1-2)

15. Embed Phorest booking widget on-site (or create branded interstitial)
16. Implement image optimization (WebP, srcset, lazy loading)
17. Add sticky mobile "Book Now" CTA
18. Update privacy policy to current standards
19. Create custom branded 404 error page
20. Reduce robots.txt crawl-delay to 2-3 seconds
21. Clean up duplicate service routes
22. Implement critical CSS and defer non-essential JS

Long-Term (Months 2-6)

23. Resume blog content strategy (monthly posts)
24. Implement review schema with real Google/Yelp aggregate data
25. Build FAQ section with FAQ schema

- 26. Create branded email (contact@mintontheavenue.com)
 - 27. Conduct live cross-browser testing in Safari and Firefox
 - 28. Implement A/B testing on booking CTA placement
 - 29. Add live chat or messaging integration
-

16. CRO Recommendations Summary

#	Recommendation	Effort	Impact	Priority
1	Fix team page	Low	Very High	P0
2	Add service pricing	Low	Very High	P0
3	Unify offers	Low	High	P0
4	Sticky mobile CTA	Medium	High	P1
5	On-site booking embed	High	Very High	P1
6	Social proof in hero	Low	Medium	P1
7	Service price previews on homepage	Low	Medium	P2
8	FAQ on booking page	Medium	Medium	P2
9	Live chat widget	Medium	Medium	P2
10	A/B test CTA copy	Low	Medium	P2
11	Exit-intent new guest offer	Medium	Medium	P3
12	Retargeting pixel setup	Low	Medium	P3

17. Prioritized Fix Roadmap

● Phase 1: Emergency Fixes (This Week)

- ☐ Fix Meet the Team page
- ☐ Fix /our-artists 404
- ☐ Unify new guest offer
- ☐ Restrict REST API
- ☐ Add security headers

● Phase 2: Critical Improvements (Weeks 2-4)

- ☐ Meta descriptions for all pages
- ☐ Heading hierarchy fixes
- ☐ Service pricing
- ☐ Schema.org markup
- ☐ OG images
- ☐ Fix mixed content
- ☐ Standardize hours
- ☐ Accessibility fixes (alt text, form labels, ARIA)

● Phase 3: Enhancement (Month 2)

- ☐ On-site booking experience
- ☐ Image optimization pipeline
- ☐ Sticky mobile CTA
- ☐ Custom 404 page
- ☐ Privacy policy update
- ☐ Performance optimization

○ Phase 4: Growth (Months 3-6)

- ☐ Content strategy relaunch
- ☐ Review schema integration
- ☐ Cross-browser testing
- ☐ A/B testing program
- ☐ Messaging/chat integration

Appendix A: Complete Route Inventory

See Section 3.2 for full route listing with 33 pages and 40+ blog posts.

Appendix B: WordPress REST API Namespaces Exposed

Namespace	Risk Level	Description
`wp/v2`	[MED] Medium	Standard WP endpoints (posts, pages, media, users)
`wordfence/v1`	[CRIT] Critical	Security plugin — scan, config, auth endpoints
`wpe/cache-plugin/v1`	[CRIT] Critical	WP Engine cache control
`wpe_sign_on_plugin/v1`	[MED] Medium	SSO login endpoints
`seopress/v1`	[MED] Medium	SEO config, export, content analysis

`duplicate-post/v1`	[LOW] Low	Post duplication utility
`oembed/1.0`	[LOW] Low	oEmbed discovery (standard)

Appendix C: Blog Post Content Age Analysis

Year	Posts	Status
2022	6	Most recent
2021	12	Active year
2020	10	Active year
2019	10	Active year
2018	8	Early content
2017	4	Launch era

Gap: Zero posts from July 2022 to present (nearly 4 years).

End of Report

This audit was conducted non-destructively and all findings are based on publicly accessible information. No authentication was bypassed, no forms were submitted, and no systems were modified during this assessment.

